The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

FRANCE

EDITION 10. A — TRENCHES CORRECTED TO 20-11-17. — SHEET 51B N.W.

INSTRUCTIONS AS TO THE USE OF THE SQUARES.

3. When more accurate definition is wanted (on the 1:20,000 or 1:10,000 scales) use exactly the same method, but divide sides into 100 parts and use four figures instead of two. Thus 0847 denotes 08 parts East and 47 parts North of origin (see point X). Point Y is 6503.

4. Use 0 but not 10; use either two or four figures: do not use fractions (3½, 4½, etc).

CONTOUR INTERVAL 5 METRES.

ALL HEIGHTS IN METRES

TABLE FOR CONVERTING METRES TO FEET.

Metres	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
0	0	3·3	6·6	9·8	13·1	16·4	19·7	23·0	26·2	29·5
10	32·8	36·1	39·4	42·6	45·9	49·2	52·5	55·8	59·0	62·3
20	65·6	68·9	72·2	75·4	78·7	82·0	85·3	88·6	91·8	95·1
30	98·4	101·7	105·0	108·2	111·5	114·8	118·1	121·4	124·6	127·9
40	131·2	134·5	137·8	141·0	144·3	147·6	150·9	154·1	157·4	160·7
50	164·0	167·3	170·6	173·8	177·1	180·4	183·7	187·0	190·2	193·5
60	196·8	200·1	203·4	206·6	209·9	213·2	216·5	219·8	223·0	226·3
70	229·6	232·9	236·2	239·4	242·7	246·0	249·3	252·6	255·8	259·1
80	262·4	265·7	269·0	272·2	275·5	278·8	282·1	285·4	288·6	291·9
90	295·2	298·5	301·8	305·0	308·3	311·6	314·9	318·1	321·4	324·7
100	328·0	331·3	334·6	337·8	341·1	344·4	347·7	351·0	354·2	357·5

On squared maps all bearings should be given with reference to the vertical grid lines, which are parallel to the East and West edges of the sheet. Bearings should always be reckoned clockwise from 0° to 360°.

Grid bearings are less than compass bearings, the difference being called the correction of the compass. To find out what this deviation is, take a compass bearing to a distant point, and measure on the map the grid bearing to that point. The difference between the two bearings is the deviation of that compass from Grid North. To obtain the grid bearing of any point the deviation must be subtracted from the compass bearing (adding 360° to the latter if necessary).

On this sheet the mean deviation of a normal compass is 0° 0′ ; but to obtain accurate results the exact deviation of each compass should be tested as described above, and this test should be repeated in each locality.

Ordnance Survey, January 1918.

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GLOSSARY.

Abbaye, Abbᵉ	Abbey.
Abreuvoir, Abᵗ	Watering place.
Abri de douaniers	Customs-shelter.
Aciérie	Steel works.
Aiguilles	Points (Ry.)
Allée	Alley, Narrow road
Ancien - ne, Anᵉ⁻ⁿᵉ	Old.
Aqueduc	Aqueduct.
Arbre	Tree
" écartail	" fan-shaped.
" déchaussé	" bare.
" fourchu	" forked.
" incliné	" inclined.
" penché	" leaning.
Arbrisseau	Small tree.
Arc	Arch.
Ardoisière, Ardⁱᵉ	Slate quarry.
Arrêt	Halt.
Asile	Asylum.
" des aliénés	Lunatic asylum.
" d'	
" de charité	
" des pauvres	Asylum.
" de refuge	
Auberge, Aubᵉ	Inn.
Aune	Alder-tree.
Bac	Ferry.
" à traille	"
Baine	Baths.
Place aux baine	Bathing place.
Balise	Buoy, Beacon.
Banc de sable	Sand-bank.
" " vase	Mud-bank.
Barique	Hut.
Barrage	Dam.
Barrière	Gate, Stile.
(Machine à) Bascule	Weigh-bridge.
Bassin	Dock, Pond.
" d'échouage	Tidal dock.
Bassin de radoub	Dry dock.
Batteau phare	Light-ship.
Blanchisserie	Laundry.
B.M. (borne milliaire)	Mile stone.
Bᵉ (borne kilométrique)	
Boulonnerie, Fabᵉ de boulons	Bolt Factory.
Boule	Buoy.
Brasserie, Brasᵉ	Brewery.
Briqueterie, Briqᵉ	Brick-field.
Brise-lames	Breakwater.
Bureau de poste	Post office.
" de douane	Custom house.
Butte	Butt, Mound.
Cabane	Hut.
Cabaret, Cabᵗ	Inn.
Câble sous-marin	Submarine cable.
Calvaire, Calvᵉ	Calvary.
Canal de dessèchement	Drainage canal.
Canal d'irrigation	Irrigation canal.
Fabᵉ de caoutchouc	Rubber factory.
Carrière, Carᵉ	Quarry.
" de gravier	Gravel-pit.
Caserne	Barracks.
Champ de courses	Race-course.
" " manœuvres	Drill-ground.
" " tir	Rifle range.
Chantier	Building yard. Ship yard. Dock yard.
Chantier de construction	Slip-way.
Chapelle, Chᵉ	Chapel.
Charbonnage	Colliery.
Château d'eau	Water tower.
Chaussée	Causeway. Highway.
Chemin de fer	Railway.
Cheminée, Cheᵉ	Chimney.
Chêne	Oak tree.
Cimetière, Cimᵉ	Cemetery.
Clocher	Belfry.
Clouterie	Nail factory.
Colombier	Dove-cot.
Corps	Workmen's dwellings.
Cour des marchandises	Goods yard.
Couvent	Convent.
Crassier	Slag heap.
Croix	Cross.
Darse	Inner dock.
Démoli - e	Destroyed.
Détruit - e, Détᵗ⁻ᵉ	"
Déversoir	Weir.
Digue	Dyke, causeway.
Distillerie, Distᵉ	Distillery.
Douane	Custom-house.
Bureau de douane	
Entrepôt de douane	Custom warehouse.
Dynamitière, Dynamᵉ	Dynamite magazine.
Dynamiterie	Dynamite factory.
Ecluse	Sluice, Lock.
Ecluseite, Eclᵉ	Sluice.
Ecole	School.
Ecurie	Stable.
Eglise	Church.
Emaillerie	Enamel works.
Embarcadère, Embᵉ	Landing-place.
Estaminet, Estaᵗ	Inn.
Etang	Pond.
Fabrique, Fabᵉ	Factory.
Fabᵉ de produits chimiques	Chemical works.
Fabᵉ de faïence	Pottery.
Faïencerie	
Ferme, Fᵉ	Farm.
Filature, Filᵉ	Spinning mill.
Fonderie, Fondᵉ	Foundry.
Fontaine, Fontᵉ	Spring, fountain.
Forêt	Forest.
Forme de radoub	Dry dock.
Forge	Smithy.
Fosse	Mine, Pit.
Fossé	Moat, Ditch.
Four	Kiln.
" à chaux	Lime-kiln.
Four à coke	Coke oven.
Ganterie	Glove Factory.
Gare	Station.
Garenne	Warren.
Garnison	Garrison.
Gazomètre	Gasometer.
Glacerie, Fabᵉ de glaces	Mirror Factory.
Glacière	Ice factory.
Grue	Crane.
Gué	Ford.
Guérite	Sentry-box, Turret.
" à signaux	Signal-box (Ry.)
Halle	Hall.
Hangar	Shed, Hangar.
Hôpital	Hospital.
Hôtel-de-Ville	Town hall.
Houillère	Colliery.
Huilerie	Oil factory.
Imprimerie, Impᵉ	Printing works.
Jetée	Pier.
Laminerie	Rolling mills.
Ligne de haute mer	High water mark.
Laisse de basse mer	Low " "
Maison Forestière, Mⁿ. Fˢᵗᵉ.	Forester's house.
Malterie	Malt-house.
Marbrerie	Marble works.
Marais	Marsh.
Marais salant	Saltern, Salt marsh.
Marché	Market.
Mare	Pool.
Meule	Rick.
Minière	Mine.
Monastère	Monastery.
Moulin, Mⁱⁿ	Mill.
" à vapeur	Steam mill.
Mur	Wall.
" crénelé	Loop-holed wall.
Nacelle	
Usine	
Orphelinat	
Ouvrière	
Ouvrages	
Ouvrages hydrauliques	
Papeterie	
Parc	
" aérostatique	
" à charbon	
" à pétrole	
Passage à niveau	
Passerelle, Passᵉ	
Pépinière	
Peuplier	
Phare	
Pilier, Pilʳ	
Plaine d'exercice	
Pompe	
Poterne	
Pont	
" levis	
Poste de garde	
Station	
Poteau Iᵉˡˡᵉ	
Poterie	
Poudrière, Poudᵉ	
Magasin à poudre	
Prise d'eau	
Puits	
" artésien	
" d'aérage	
" ventilateur	
" de sondage	
Quai	
" aux bestiaux	
" aux marchandises	
" des	
Raccordement	
Raffinerie	
" de sucre	
Régerie	

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à coke	Coke oven.
verie	Glove Factory.
Station	Station.
Wattrie	Watrer.
Caserne	Garrison.
Géomètre	Geometer.
Miroiterie de glaces	Mirror Factory.
Glacière	Ice factory.
Crane	Crane.
Fond	Ford.
Sentinelle, Tourelle à signaux	Sentry-box, Turret, Signal-box (Ry.)
Halle	Hall.
Hangar	Shed, Hangar.
Hôpital	Hospital.
Hôtel-de-Ville	Town hall.
Houillère	Colliery.
Huilerie	Oil factory.
Imprimerie, Imprie	Printing works.
Jetée	Pier.
Laminoir	Rolling mills.
Laisse de haute mer	High water mark.
Laisse de basse mer	Low " "
Maison Forestière	Forester's house.
Malterie	Malt-house.
Marbrerie	Marble works.
Marais	Marsh.
Marais salant	Saltern, Salt marsh.
Marché	Market.
Puit	Pixel.
Brique	Brick.
Mine	Mine.
Monastère	Monastery.
Moulin, Mie	Mill.
Moulin à vapeur	Steam mill.
Mur	Wall.
Mur isolé	Long-boiled wall.

Nacelle	Ferry.
Orme	Elm.
Orphelinat	Orphanage.
Osseraie	Osier-beds.
Ouvrage	Fort.
Ouvrages hydrauliques	Water works.
Papeterie	Paper-mill.
Parc	Park, yard.
" aérostatique	Aviation ground.
" à charbon	Coal yard.
" à pétrole	Petrol store.
Passage à niveau P.N.	Level-crossing.
Passerelle, Pnle	Foot-bridge.
Pépinière	Nursery-garden.
Peuplier	Poplar tree.
Phare	Light-house.
Pilier, Pr	Post.
Plaine d'exercice	Drill ground.
Pompe	Pump.
Ponceau	Culvert.
Pont	Bridge.
" levis	Drawbridge.
Poste de garde-côte	Coast-guard station.
Poteau Ie	Post.
Poterie	Pottery.
Poudrière, Poudre, Magasin à poudre	Powder magazine.
Prise d'eau	Water supply.
Puits	Pit-head, Shaft, Well.
" artésien	Artesian well.
" d'aérage, " ventilateur	Ventilating shaft.
" de sondage	Boring.
Quai	Quay, Platform.
" aux bestiaux	Cattle platform.
" aux marchandises	Goods platform.
Raccordement	Junction.
Raffinerie	Refinery.
" de sucre	Sugar refinery
Rizerie	Rice-root factory.

Remblai	Embankment.
Remise des Machines	Engine-shed.
Réservoir, Rvr	Reservoir.
Route carrossable	Bridle road.
Rubanerie	Ribbon Factory.
Ruine, Ruines, En ruine, Ruiné - e	Ruin.
Sablière	Sand-pit.
Sablonnière, Sablonne	"
Sapin	Fir tree.
Saule	Willow tree.
Saunerie	Salt-works.
Scierie, Sie	Saw-mill.
Sondage	Boring.
Source	Spring.
Sucrerie, Sue	Sugar factory.
Tannerie	Tannery.
Tir à la cible	Rifle range.
Tissage	Weaving mill.
Tilerie	Rolling mill
Tonneau	Tomb.
Tour	Tower.
Tourbière	Peat-bog, Peat-bed.
Tourelle	Small tower.
Tuilerie	Tile works.
Usine à gaz	Gas works.
" électrique, " d'électricité	Electricity works.
" métallurgique	Metal works.
" à agglomérés	Briquette factory.
Verrerie, Verre	Glass works.
Viaduc	Viaduct
Vivier	Fish Pond.
Voie de chargement, " déchargement, " d'évitement, " formation, " manœuvre	Siding.
Zinguerie	Zinc works.

WAR DIARY ORIGINAL 1/IG.

TRENCH MAP.

FRANCE.

SHEET 51B N.W.

EDITION 10. A

INDEX TO ADJOINING SHEETS

SCALE 1/20,000.

9121 | Sh. 9M

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1ST GDS BDE

1ST BATT. IRISH GDS

AUG 1914 JAN 1914

FROM 2 DIV 4 BDE

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

WAR DIARY

1st BATTN. IRISH GUARDS.

S E P T E M B E R

1 9 1 5

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On His Majesty's Service.

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WAR DIARY
or
INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY.
(*Erase heading not required.*)

Army Form C. 2118.

1

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 1st 1915.	The Battalion remained in billets in LE PREOL all day, and the men were able to bathe in the Canal.	Reference map as for July
August 2nd 5 p.m.	The Battalion relieved 2nd GRENADIERS in the trenches at 5 p.m.	
	On the recommendation of Captain MOMBER of 176th R.E Company - a mining Company - it was decided to blow up 3 mines just East of SUNKEN ROAD because he considered that the Enemy mine galleries were coming too close, and it was hoped to destroy them by this means, and perhaps blow up some of the Enemy's front line trench.	
	Arrangements were made to occupy the Crater formed as soon as the explosion took place, and if as was hoped the Enemy front line was damaged to occupy it.	
6-30 p.m.	The C.O went round the trenches with Captain MOMBER at 6-30 p.m. and final arrangements were made especially as to how far troops were to be withdrawn when the explosion took place. It was also decided to explode the mines at 8-30 p.m. and the BRIGADE, and Artillery were so informed.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

2

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 2nd 8-33 p.m.	At 8-33 p.m the explosion took place and soon after the rear lip of the Crater ~~was~~ numbered 4 — was occupied, and a trench immediately dug in rear of it bending back into the front line again. Out of this saps were made in order to see into the crater. Although 3 mines had been sprung only one big crater was formed the length of which was about 50 yds. The Artillery fired on certain points of the Enemy's line as arranged in order to prevent any possible concentration, and to cover the men engaged in digging the new trench	
9 p.m.	About 9 p.m the Enemy began to reply with Artillery Machine guns and bombs, but very little rifle fire. This continued for some time, and his front trench near the point of his line was heavily bombarded by Battalion bombers with hand grenades, over 400 of which were thrown during the course of the night. These bombers did excellent work especially No 4906 Pte J. HENRY, who although wounded continued to throw hand grenades amid a perfect hail of Enemy bombs, and did not cease till he was again wounded and asked back to the Regimental Aid Post. These bombers greatly assisted the men employed on the new line,	

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Army Form C. 2118.

3

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 2nd 11 p.m.	and also prevented the enemy from occupying the far lip of the crater. About this hour Lt. Hon. H. HARMSWORTH who was in charge of the digging party was wounded in the head by a bullet from one of the machine guns which were causing some annoyance. Artillery was brought to bear on them but did not have much effect, therefore it was decided to fire trench mortars at the place where it was thought they were - This apparently had the desired effect, and by midnight all was quiet and work went on uninterruptedly for some hours.	
12 M.N.	Casualties this day were 1 man killed, 1 officer and 7 men wounded.	
August 3rd 6-30 a.m.	The C.O visited the trenches at 6-30 a.m and went round the new trench on the near side of the new Crater 4. The work had been well done, the whole affair had been carried out by No 1 Company under Capt M.V. GORE-LANGTON and great energy and determination had been shown by all ranks.	
10 a.m.	Major-General A.S. HORNE, Commanding 2nd Division, and the BRIGADIER came up to H.Q.s about 10 a.m and	

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Army Form C. 2118.

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 3rd	discussed various points about the situation, and later on Lt. General HUBERT GOUGH, Commanding 1st ARMY CORPS came in.	
	The day passed off quietly, and the C.O went round the trenches again in the evening and arranged for an attempt to be made to reconnoitre Crater No. 3, as he wished to link it up with Craters No 1 and 2 so as to form a Continuous line behind them and back again into the main line trench.	
8-30 p.m.	a patrol under Lt H. F. LAW was sent out which succeeded in reaching the crater, and after throwing some hand grenades into it was able to report that it was unoccupied, and immediately work was begun to dig out along the Northern Edge of the ORCHARD to it, and also from No 2 crater. This was successfully accomplished by the morning, although the working parties were somewhat interfered with by the enemy. But with the aid of trench mortars and hand grenades he was eventually silenced.	
	The Casualties this day were 4 men wounded.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 4th 6-30 a.m	The C.O and adjt. went round the trenches at 6-30 a.m and as they arrived at the front line the enemy began to send over some large Minenwerfer bombs. These continued at the rate of one every three minutes for an hour and a half. A portion of one of these shells was found, the base of it measured 7 inches across. The explosion was very great but not much damage was done. They were replied to by 47th Howitzer BATTERY and our own trench mortars.	
	The C.O visited the Crater No 3, and also Nos 1 and 2 where the new work had been done.	
9 a.m	From 9 a.m onwards the enemy were quite quiet, and a good deal of work ~~could be~~ was carried out during the day.	
10 a.m	The BRIGADIER came up about 10 a.m, and discussed various points about the situation.	
5 p.m	The Battalion was relieved by 2nd GRENADIERS about 5 p.m, and marched back to billets in LE. PREOL	
	The Casualties this day were 3 men killed, & 3 wounded	

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Army Form C. 2118.

6.

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 5th	The Battalion remained in billets in LE PREOL the whole day, and the men were able to bathe in the Canal. 2nd Lt. R. W. HEARD returned from leave this day.	
August 6th 5pm	The Battalion relieved the GRENADIERS at about 5 p.m. They had had several casualties through the explosion of an enemy mine in the ORCHARD, but no damage was done to our trenches only to one or two Sap heads in the craters.	
6-30pm	At 6-30 p.m. the C.O went round the trenches and arranged for work to be done during the night, which consisted chiefly in digging out new Saps again and putting up some wire.	
8-30pm.	At 8-30 p.m. it was reported to me that the mining officer heard the enemy working in one of their galleries at a distance of only 12 feet and it was decided to blow up an immediate. This could not be done till the early morning, and in the meantime I held all Saps & trenches very lightly in case the enemy exploded their mine first.	
August 7th 5-50 a.m.	The night passed off quite quietly, and at 5-50 a.m. the mine referred to above was exploded. It considerably damaged the Saps & the craters which all had to be dug. The O.C. went round the trenches about 6-30 a.m.	
6-30 a.m.		

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7

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 7th 9-15 a.m.	The Brigadier came up to Batt Head quarters at 9-15 a.m. and saw there C.O of 2nd & 3rd B= COLDSTREAM GUARDS, and the C.O on certain matters.	
2-15 p.m.	At 2-15 p.m Major H. LEWIN from the Staff of 1st CORPS, came up and was taken all round the trenches by the C.O.	
	Captain J.H.T. PRIESTMAN, LINCOLNSHIRE REGT, an instructor at R.M.C SANDHURST arrived to be attached to the section for a few days to see how things are carried on.	
	Casualties this day were one man wounded.	
August 8th	The night was rather noisy, but not much damage was done. The C.O went round about 6-30 a.m accompanied	
6-30 a.m	by Captain PRIESTMAN and the Adjutant. There was a bomb accident about this time, caused by a man who was on sentry in a sap with a bomber. This man thought he could throw a bomb, but not knowing how to blew himself up and wounded the bomber.	
	The work done during the night consisted in wiring certain places, repairing and deepening saps.	
9 a.m.	At 9 a.m the enemy began shelling the front line, and getting it in enfilade from the direction of AUCHY, and caused several casualties, two men being blown to pieces.	

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Army Form C. 2118.

8.

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 8th 11-30 a.m.	At 11-30 a.m this heavy shelling began again from the same direction and lasted till 1 p.m, but did no damage with the exception of blowing in the trenches in one or two places.	
5 p.m	The Battalion was relieved by GRENADIERS about 5 p.m and marched back to billets.	
	The Casualties this day were Six men killed, and nine men wounded. Information was received that No 4906 Pte HENRY had been awarded the D. C. M.	
August 9th	The Battalion remained in billets during the whole of this day. One man attd to the Mining Coy was killed this day.	
August 10th 5 p.m.	The Battalion relieved the GRENADIERS in the trenches at 5 p.m. They had had a rather an unlucky day, having lost 1 officer killed and one wounded.	
	Since the Battalion was last in these trenches the Enemy had blown up a mine on the Salient among the many other craters there, which had the effect of	

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Army Form C. 2118.

9

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 10th	forming another very deep crater, behind the NEW PYRAMID as shown on Map 1, attached d/- Aug 10th. This is an Eye Sketch drawn by Lt G. YERBURGH from the left of the line.	
6 p.m.	The C.O went round the trenches at 6 p.m. It was thought possible that, since the latest German explosion had completely destroyed their own wire at the point of the Salient which was immediately behind NEW PYRAMID, but on the far side, i.e Eastern side of the Crater there formed, an entry might be effected into their trenches. Arrangements were made for a patrol to move out and examine the ground after dark, and in the event of a way being found in preparations were made for the necessary troops to be at hand.	
9-45 p.m.	At 9-45 p.m, Battalion Headquarters moved forward to NEW CUT, and the BRIGADIER came up also.	

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10

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 10th 10-15 p.m.	About 10-15 p.m the patrol under 2Lt A.F.L. GORDON returned with the information that the slopes of the Craters were too steep, and that it was impossible to get up them. The route taken is shown on Map 1. During the night several attempts by the enemy to work in and near the Craters were interfered with by the throwing of bombs from our side of these Craters. Another mine had been blown up on our extreme right by us since the Battalion was last in these trenches. This explosion destroyed all our own Saps 1, 2, 3, 4 and the Eastern end of the SAP LOOP, and all these had to be re-dug during the night.	
Aug 11th 6-30 a.m	The night passed off comparatively quietly – The C.O and Adjutant went round at 6-30 a.m, and carefully reconnoitre the position with a view to offensive action. It seemed impossible to get near the enemys trenches from the Eastern end of the Salient, but there appeared	

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11

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 11th 6 p.m.	to be a way across the crater opposite observing post C, as this crater had been considerably filled up by earth thrown into it from the last German mine explosion. The day was quite quiet, and about 6 p.m the C.O went up and selected places from which General HORNE could get a good view of the position, as he proposed to come up and reconnoitre it tomorrow. The C.O also arranged with Captain GORE-LANGTON to reconnoitre the enemy's wire across the crater opposite observing Post C. This he undertook to do himself.	
10 p.m.	At 10 p.m Captain GORE-LANGTON reported that he had been out across the crater, and found another one which extended right up to the enemy's line. Whilst lying out a German was seen within 8 yds of him and he was killed by Pte O'CONNOR, who with Pte DEMPSEY, accompanied Captain GORE-LANGTON.	

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12

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 11th 10-30 p.M.	This reconnaissance was particularly well carried out by Captain GORE-LANGTON, and he returned with some very valuable information. The first of 3 bomb fights which took place during the night occurred at this time, the cause being that the Enemy heard a working party of ours beginning a sap out and made an observation post up to the summit of NEW PYRAMID. No casualties occurred on our side, but many groans & shrieks came from the crater below.	
11-45 p.M.	The next fight took place about 11-45 p.M. and the cause was as follows - Captain GORE-LANGTON had come out with another man to put a piece of wire in the shallow crater which he had previously walked across. He fell in with a covering party of the enemy who were working on their wire. They threw bombs at him and he only got back to his trenches with difficulty being knocked down three times by the explosion of bombs, but not injured, only slightly shaken. Then they began the second bomb fight,	

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13

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Aug 11th	on them replying vigorously - This lasted for about half an hour, and was accompanied by a good deal of Enemy rifle and machine gun fire, and was only stopped by artillery fire being brought to bear on the Enemy trenches - There were no Casualties on our side.	*Casualties this day were 5 men wounded
August 12th 2-30 a.m	The third and last bomb fight took place at this hour and was caused by hearing some enemy working parties in the craters below, at which our bombers hurled some bombs - The enemy replied, but did not inflict any Casualties. Throughout the entire night the bombers were employed in dispersing working parties, and the services rendered by them were quite invaluable.	
6-30 a.m	The C.O and Adjutant went round the trenches at 6-30 a.m and saw the 2 observing positions made for General HORNE, and then the work which had been done during the night.	
9-15 a.m	At 9-15 a.m General HORNE Lt. VAUGHAN, his	

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14

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 12th 9-15 a.m.	Staff Officer and the BRIGADIER came up to B2 Head 3, and the C.O explained to them the events of the night. They then went all round the trenches and the whole position was explained to General HORNE, who visited every Sap head and saw everything possible. The remainder of the day was perfectly quiet, and the Battalion was relieved by the GRENADIERS at about 5 p.m. During the afternoon a message came to the C.O to say that he had been appointed to command the 20th Infantry Brigade. The Casualties this day were Nil.	
August 13th	The Battalion remained in billets for the whole of this day. The C.O obtained leave to remain with the Battalion until after it came out of the trenches on 15th Captain J.H.T. PRIESTMAN who had been attached since 7th inst left this day.	

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15.

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 14th 11-45 a.m.	The C.O saw each company on their Company parade grounds and said Goodbye to them, as he would not have another opportunity of doing so after they came out of the trenches.	
5 p.M.	The Battalion relieved the GRENADIERS about 5 p.m. and the C.O went round the trenches about 6-30 p.m. to arrange the work for the night.	
August 15th 6-30 a.m.	The C.O went up to the trenches with the Adjutant at 6-30 a.m and saw the work which had been done during the night. Throughout the night much bombing had taken place but with no casualties to any man of the Battalion.	
5 p.M.	At 5 p.m. the Battalion was relieved by 52nd OXFORD-SHIRE and BUCKINGHAM LIGHT INFANTRY, and marched back to billets in BETHUNE which were in MONTMORENCY BARRACKS.	
9-30 p.M	A Wire came from Colonel PROBY stating that Major MADDEN was coming out to take command of the Battalion.	

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16

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 15th	The Battalion remained in Billets in BETHUNE all the day. The Commanding Officer Lt Colonel. The Hon^ble J. Trefusis D.S.O having been promoted ~~Temp~~ Temporary Brigadier General on August 12th, and having been appointed to Command the 20th Infantry Brigade, left the Battalion to take up his new Command. He was in Command of the Battalion from the end of November 1914 up to the present date, and it is impossible to express in words all he has done for the Battalion. He leaves with the sincere regret of all ranks, and he will be a very great loss to the Battalion. Major G H C Madden arrived from England and took over the Command. The 2nd Bn Irish Guards left Warley Barracks. Boulogne for the Front. The Battalion was allotted the Hot Baths in Bethune, and were able to bathe 120 men and get their clothes disinfected.	
August 16th	The Battalion remained in Billets in BETHUNE all this day. The Companies were employed in the Morning in Company drill and Company Training under their own Officers. The C.O. then viewed Barracks today.	

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17

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 18	The Battalion remained in Billets in BETHUNE all today. The Companies went out route marching under their own officers, there was a very heavy Thunder storm during the morning, two Companies unfortunately got caught in this and got very wet. The C.O and Adjutant rode out to see the Companies Route marching. The C.O attended at the Brigade Office at 12. Noon to receive orders as regards the move of the 4th Guards Brigade which takes place Tomorrow. The Battalion was allotted the public Swimming Baths today, and the Companies were all marched to these Baths, and the have all bathed.	

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18

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 19th	The Battalion left BETHUNE today and marched through LILLERS to St HILAIRE where they billetted for the night. The Battalion as part of the 4th Guards Brigade Coand to be a unit of the 2nd Division today. Major General Horne and the 2nd Divisional staff took up a position on the road passing through VENDIN-LEZ-BETHUNE and the 4th Guards Brigade Marched ~~past~~ him, he issued a farewell Order which was read out to the Troops. Thirty men of each unit belonging to the 2nd Division lined the Road, and cheered the 4th Guards Brigade as they marched past; a Complete Co? of the 1st Herts Territorials attended, this Battalion has formed part of the 4th Guards Brigade Since December 1914, and the Brigade Co very Sorry to part with them. The ~~2nd Divisional Band~~ The 1st Kings Liverpool Regiment played the Irish Guards out of BETHUNE.	Reference Map HAZEBROUCK 5A 1/100,000
4.30 pm	The C.o went round the Billets at St Hilaire. Captain Blake went on leave to England today.	
August 20th	The Battalion left St HILAIRE at 7.50 a.m and marched through AIRE and billetted at CAMPAGNE	

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19

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
4-0 pm	The 4th Guards Brigade marched past General Sir Douglas Haig he was greatly pleased by the appearance of the Brigade, he wrote a most complimentary Order bidding the 4th Guards Brigade farewell on their ceasing to be part of the 1st Army. An Army Order was issued today stating that the 4th Guards Brigade now became the 1st Guards Brigade. The C.O went round the billets which are extremely good ones.	
August 21st	The Battalion left CAMPAGNE at 8-0 a.m and Marched to EPERLECQUES When ~~they~~ it went into Billets The Commander in chief and all his staff took up a position in the Central Square of St OMER and the 4th Guards Brigade marched past him; The Brigadier General commanding the 4th Guards Brigade informed the C.O that the C in C was greatly impressed and pleased by the appearance of the Brigade The Billets of the Battalion at EPERLECQUES are particularly good. Lieut Hargreaves went on Leave to England today.	
August 22nd	The Battalion remained in billets at EPERLECQUES There was Voluntary Church and chapel Services for all ranks	
12-Noon	The C.O went round the Billets	

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20

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 23rd	The Battalion remained in Billets at EPERLECQUES. There was Company training and drill under Company Commanders during the morning.	
2.15 p.m.	The C.O gave a lecture to all Officers and N.C.O's on Protection on the March.	
	The C.O and Adjutant motored over to ACQUIN where the 2nd Bn Irish Guards are billeted, here they met Lt Colonel The Hon Leslie Butler commanding the 2nd Battalion, and arranged for the transfer of Officers and N.C.O's from the 1st to the 2nd Battalion.	
August 24th	The Battalion Left EPERLECQUES at 8.0 a.m and marched through LUMBRES to THIEMBRONNE where they went into billets.	
	The length of the march today was about 19 miles, the Battalion marched extremely well only 5 men falling out on the march.	
	Lieut GORDON returned from Leave in England today and 2nd Lieut STEVENS went on leave to England.	
August 25th	The Battalion remained in Billets today in THIEMBRONNE.	
	The Companies spent the morning cleaning up their Billets and settling down, the Battalion is likely to remain here for sometime	
12.0 Noon	The C.O went round Billets.	

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21

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 26th	The Battalion remained in Billets today at THIEMBRONNE The Companies spent the Morning in Company Drill and Extended Order drill under their Company Commanders.	
2.15. P.M.	The C.O gave a lecture to all Officers & N.C.O's on Outposts. The C.O was notified today that the undermentioned Officer and N.C.Os have been awarded Decorations viz: The Military Cross. Captain W. V. GORELANGTON. 1st Bn Irish Guards. The Distinguished Conduct Medal No 2760 Privat. J. O'Connor. 1st Bn Irish Guards (clasp to D.C.M) No 4868 Privat. R. Dempsey. 1st Bn Irish Guards.	
August 27th	The Battalion remained in Billets today at THIEMBRONNE The Companies spent the morning in Company Drill and practice of Advanced. Regs. of Irish Guards.	
2.15 p.m.	In the afternoon Company Commanders gave lectures to their Companies on Outposts.	
August 28th	The Battalion remained in Billets today at THIEMBRONNE	
8.30 a.m.	The Battalion paraded for Battalion drill, the Battalion drilled extraordinarily well considering that no practice has been possible for some months.	

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22

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
August 29th	The Battalion remained in billets in THIEMBRONNE There were voluntary church and chapel Services for all ranks	
August 30th	The Battalion remained in billets in THIEMBRONNE.	
9 a.m.	The Battalion marched to St PIERRE taking part in the 1st Line Transport.	
	The 2nd Bn Irish Guards billetted at ACQUIN also marched to St PIERRE	
	the two Battalions met and bivouaced in a field.	
	This is the 1st meeting between the two Service Battalions of Irish Guards.	
	It was a beautiful day and the two Battalions had their Dinners	
	together, and all ranks much appreciated the meeting, it being a great	
	occasion for Irish Guardsmen.	
1.30 p.m.	Both Battalions marched back to their respective billets.	
August 31st	The Battalion remained in billets in THIEMBRONNE	
	The Cos spent the morning in Field Training and Coy Drill under	
	their Coy Commanders.	
	The 2nd in Command Captain T. BAILEY inspected the billets today.	
	The C.O and Machine Gun Officer attended a Course of Lectures	
	and demonstrations in the Field at the Machine Gun School at WISQUES.	
	Lieut P.H. Ainsley and Lieut C.D Wyatt were promoted Temporary Captains today	
	2nd Lieuts the Hon. H.R.O'Brien and 2nd Lieut A.E Gordon were promoted Temporary Lieuts today	

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1

All references to map HAZEBROUCK 5A 1/100,000

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
September 1st	The Battalion remained in billets at THIEMBRONNE	
8.40 a.m.	The Battalion paraded for a Divisional field day. The object of the field day was to practice March Discipline and intercommunication between Brigades on the March. The Battalion marched past Major General Sir Francis Lloyd today. The Battalion returned to billets at 4.0 p.m.	
September 2nd	The Battalion remained in billets at THIEMBRONNE	
	The Co's during the morning practised Extended Order Drill and Rear Guards under their Co's Commanders.	
2.15 p.m.	The C.O gave a lecture on Infantry in Attack to all officers and N.C.O's above the rank of L/Corporal.	
September 3rd	The Battalion remained in billets at THIEMBRONNE	
	The Co's during the morning practised Outposts and also did some Extended order drill.	
September 4th	The Battalion remained in billets at THIEMBRONNE. a draft of 2 N.C.O's and 48 men joined the Battalion today. The Co's have exercised in drill and Field Training under their Co's Commanders.	
	The C.O attended at the Brigade Office with all the Co's of the 1st Guards Brigade. The points discussed were (1) A Scheme of training for the Brigade when in rest Billets (2) Future movements of the Guards Division which were of course Confidential.	

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2

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
September 5th	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE This was Sunday and there were Services for all Ranks.	
September 6th	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE The Battalion was Exercised in the attack of a Village. The Village of DRIONVILLE was chosen as the one to be attacked, the attack was Extremely well carried out by all ranks. The Battalion Sports took place this afternoon and were a Great Success, the French Villagers from THIEMBRONNE attended in large Numbers.	
September 7th	The C.O Major G. H. C Madden was today Gazetted a Temporary Lieut Colonel. The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE Captain Lord Desmond Fitz Gerald returned from Leave and resumed his duties as Adjutant The Co's were Exercised in Extended Order drill and Fire Control also in advanced Guards under their C.O's Commanders.	
September 8th	The C.o prepared a Scheme for an attack by the Battalion against the Village of DRIONVILLE, this attack is to take place on Thursday Sept 9th and the Divisional General and Brigadier General are to attend. The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE	
2.30pm	The Battalion was Exercised in Battalion Drill in the morning under the C.O, and it drilled Extremely Well. ~~Orders~~ The C.o went over the Ground to be used tomorrow by the Battalion Attack with all Officers.	

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3

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
September 9th	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE The Battalion was exercised in an attack on the Village of DRIONVILLE Major General the Earl of Cavan and Brigadier General Fielden were present. 2nd Lieut Dames Longworth was this day attached to the Battalion he is an Officer of the 2nd/8th Middlesex Regiment, and an application has been forwarded, asking for his transfer to the Irish Guards.	
September 10th	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE The Coys were exercised in Route Marching under their Coy Commanders. Orderly Room Quartermaster Sergeant J Halligan was this day gazetted as a 2nd Lieut to the Leinster Regiment Captain C.D. Wynter. Lieut J. H. Wills and 2nd Lieut W.B Stevens were this day transferred to the 2nd Bn Irish Guards. 2nd Lieut T.K. Walker and 2nd Lieut T.H. Langrishe were this day transferred from the 2nd Bn Irish Guards to this Battalion.	
September 11th	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE The Battalion was exercised in Battalion Drill under the C.O	
September 12th	The Battalion remained in Billets in THIEMBRONNE There was Divine Service for all ranks and denominations Orderly Room Quartermaster Sergeant Halligan left this day to take up his appointment as a 2nd Lieut in the Leinster Regiment.	

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54

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
September 13th	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE There was a Battalion Route March in the morning Lieut. L. R. Hargreaves was today permitted to wear the badges of rank of Captain, pending his temporary promotion to that rank being announced in the London Gazette.	
September 14th	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE The Coys were exercised in outpost duty during the morning under their Coy Commanders. 2.30 p.m. The C.O gave a lecture ~~on Outposts~~ to all Officers and N.C.O's above the rank of L/Cpl on Outposts. 3.30 p.m. The C.O. Adjutant and Coy Commanders made a reconnaissance of a position which has to be occupied by the Battalion tomorrow, the Battalion having to find Outposts forming the 1st Guards Brigade during a Field day tomorrow.	
September 15th.	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE The Battalion took part in a Brigade Field Day, they left THIEMBRONNE at 7.15 a.m and got back at 4.15 p.m. ~~Lieut~~ General Haking Commanding the 11th Army Corps to which the Guards Division belongs, addressed the Officers of the 1st Guards Brigade after the Field day, he mentioned on this occasion that an attempt would shortly be made by the British Army and also by the French Army, to break the German Line. Divisional Routine Orders today mention that Captain M. V. Gee Layton received	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Sept 15. (continued)	the Military Cross, also that Pte J. O'Connor and Pte B Dempsey received the Distinguished Conduct Medal.	
September 16th	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE. Twenty metre Bursts were sent to the Village today, and the Battalion practised occupying them in as short a time as possible: This Exercise was Carried out by ½ Battalions at a time The remainder of the Morning was spent by Co's in Steady drill and Rifle Exercises under their Co's Commanders.	
2.30 p.m.	There was a lecture for all Sergeants in the Lewis M. G.	
September 17	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE The Co's were Exercised in Company drill and arm drill under their Co's Commanders during the morning.	
September 18th	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE	
8.30 a.m.	The Battalion paraded for Battalion Drill under the C.O	
	The C.O's of all Bns in the 1st Guards Brigade attended a Conference at the Bde Office at 11.45 a.m, the Subject of discussion was the future Moves and plans of the Guards Division.	
	The C.O's of all Bns in the 1st Guards Brigade Motored to the BETHUNE District, where a Reconnaissance was made of the Country held by the Germans between CUINCHY and LOOS. Government Obstruction points were used for this Reconnaissance	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
September 19th	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE Today is Sunday and Services were held for all denominations during the morning.	
September 20th	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE The morning was spent in training Co's in the attack under their Company Commanders	
2.30 pm	Captain Hargreaves gave a lecture on the Lewis machine Gun to all O/pians, and to Selected N.C.o's and men	
September 21st	The Battalion remained in Billets at THIEMBRONNE The Battalion marched to AVROULT where the 1st WBS inspected by the Colonel of the Regiment Field Marshall Earl Kitchener of Khartoum. KG. KP. de This is the first time the 1st Bn Irish Guards has been inspected by their Colonel. He made a short speech to the Battalion mentioned their distinguished services during the War, he stated that people in Ireland were greatly impressed by the deeds of the Irish Guards. The C.o called for 3 Hearty cheers for the Colonel of the Regiment, which were heartily given by all ranks.	
September 22	The Battalion remained in Billets in THIEMBRONNE during the day The Battalion was exercised in Musketry under Co Commanders Each man had to fire 10 rounds Rapid with his Smoke Helmet on.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	September 22. (Continued) Lewis Gun teams from each Co? which have been under instruction for some days, were this morning instructed in the actual firing of the Gun with ball ammunition.	
9.30 a.m.	The Co? Battalion Bombers have instructed under 2nd Lieut Tisdall in throwing live Bombs. A most regrettable and sad accident occurred this morning, a Pitcher Bomb exploded in the hand of L/Sergeant R. Matthews a Co? Bombing Sergeant killing him on the spot, and wounding 2nd Lieut Tisdall and 3 men more or less seriously. The accident was caused by a defective fuse. Captain Lord Desmond Fitz Gerald also Father Gwynn were present at the time.	
2.30 p.m.	A Court of Enquiry was held in the afternoon, and a full report was made to the 1st Guards Brigade Head Quarters.	
4.0 p.m.	No. 4160 L/Sergeant R. Matthews was buried in the grave yard close to THIEMBRONNE Church, the C.O and Lt. Colonel the Earl of Kerry attended the funeral among many others.	
6 p.m.	The Battalion left THIEMBRONNE and marched to CAPELLE-SUR-LA-LYS where it billetted for the night. 2nd Lieut C.R. Tisdall was admitted to Hospital today suffering from wounds.	
September 23rd	The Battalion remained in Billets at CAPELLE-SUR-LA-LYS during the day	
6.15 p.m.	The Battalion left CAPELLE-SUR-LA-LYS and marched to NEDON arriving there	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
September 23. (Continued)	about Midnight, it rained very heavily during the march and the troops got Wet through.	All reference Sheet 36b and Sheet 36c Scale 1:40 000
September 24 11.0am	The Battalion remained in Billets at NEDON. The C.O attended a Conference of all C.O's & General Officers of the 11th Army Corps at LILLERS, Lieutenant General Haking commanding the 11th Army Corps addressed the Officers giving a Summary of future Operations. A heavy and Continuous Bombardment could be heard from the Battalion Billets throughout the day The C.O on return to Billets about 2.30pm had a Conference of all Officers in the Battalion and Explained to the Officers what had passed at the LILLERS Conference.	
September 25 1.0pm	The Battalion left NEDON at 6.0 A.M and marched to CAUCHY-A-LA-TOUR The Battalion left for HOUVIGNEUL in pelting rain and it arrived at its destination at 9.30pm and went into Billets. 2nd Lieut D. Fitz Gerald and 30 N.C.O's and men joined the Battalion today as a draft from the Base. During the mor today the Division marched on one Road, and it was an Extremely trying march owing to the Constant halts Caused by the Road Being Blocked	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
September 26th 10 p.m.	In Billets at NOEUX LES MINES Left NOEUX LES MINES and marched in Brigade to SAILLY LA BOURSE when the Battalions were told off to various Localities. The 2nd & 3rd Bns Coldstream Guards occupied trenches East of the Captured German trenches and just West of HULLUCH The 2nd Bn Grenadier Guards was in support in the Captured German trenches and the 1st Bn Irish Guards was in trenches just East of VERMELLES close to the Water Tower in that place, Bde Head Quarters was at LE RUTOIRE. The Battalion was in position by 5.0 p.m., Bn Head Quarters was at the Water Tower. 4 Men of the Bn Machine Gun Group were wounded today on the HULLUCH Road by a premature burst of one of our own shells. Captain T. M BAILLIE was withdrawn from his Coy and posted as temporary 2nd in Command today.	
September 27th	The Battalion remained in trenches at VERMELLES during this day. The Village was heavily shelled in the morning at 12.0 noon No 2 Coy was sent forward to clean up the Battlefield. The C.O attended a Conference at Bde Head Quarters at LE RUTOIRE at 2.0 p.m. There was very heavy fighting all along the front from CUINCHY to LOOS during the day also during the early part of the night, the British bombardment of the German positions North and East of LOOS was intense. at 7.0 p.m No 3 Coy and half No 2 Coy were sent forward to dig trenches and clean up the Battlefield.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
September 27. (Continued)	2nd Lieut Grayling Major was slightly Wounded today but did not go to Hospital, 1 Man was Killed and 9 Men were Wounded today 3 of the Wounded Men did not go to Hospital. Lieuts Veysey & Rankin and 2nd Lieuts Law, Langrishe and Walker were today sent back to the 1st Line Transport to act a Reserve of Officers in accordance with the Guards Divisional Order. 2nd Lieut Christie and 20 Men joined the Battalion today as a draft from the Base. The 20th Bde was on our Left today, this Bde is Commanded by Brigadier General The Honble Trefusis D.S.O our old C.O, he came to see the Battalion today.	
September 28th	The Battalion remained in Trenches East of VERMELLES during the day. There was very heavy rain during the afternoon and early part of the night and all ranks had a very uncomfortable time as there was little or no shelter to be had. There was an intense Battle going on all day and during the early part of the night along the whole British front between CUINCHY and LOOS The Battalion Suffered no Casualties today.	

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all references to 36c N.W. Sheet 3 and part of 1. Scale 1:10000

Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
September 29th	During the early part of the day the Battalion remained in trenches at VERMELLES The C.O at 2.0 p.m. and the 4 Coy Commanders were sent for to Bde Hd Quarters at LE RUTOIRE, they were informed that the Battalion had to take over trenches from the 3rd Bde 1st Division that evening. The trenches to be occupied were just west of HULLOCH, the 2nd Bn Coldstream Guards was on our right and the 7th Division was on our Left. The C.O and Coy Commanders went forward from LE RUTOTOIRE via the BOIS CARREE and entered the old German trenches, the shell fire between LE RUTOIRE and the BOIS CARREE was heavy our artillery were blown right into the air within 100 yards of the officers as they went forward.	
6.0 p.m	The Battalion was brought forward by the Adjutant in artillery formation it moved South of LE RUTOIRE to the LONE TREE arriving there about 7.0 p.m in pitch darkness, Considerable Machine Gun fire old stuff was had to be passed through by the Battalion during this advance, but luckily most of the bullets went high. Drill Sergeant CORRY and 1 N.C.O was wounded. One man Bn Machine Gun Sergt was wounded today	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
September 30th	The C.O and 4 Guides from the 3rd Brigade met the Battalion at LONE TREE and conducted it to the trenches to be held, the Coy Commanders remained in the trenches to meet the incoming troops, the Relief of the 3rd Brigade was complete by 10.30 p.m. The Battalion remained in trenches just West of HULLUCH during the whole day. There was a good deal of Shelling and Sniping from the German lines, then was a German attack on our left flank and they captured 100 yards of the Trenches. Helped by the Scots Fusiliers The Battalion was relieved by the 3rd Bn Royal Fusiliers. Eighteen Guides under Lieut the Honble R. O'Brien met the Fusiliers at VERMELLES Church, and Conducted them by LE RUTOIRE and BOIS CARREE to the HULLUCH trenches, the relief Commenced at 8-0 p.m and was Complete by 1.45 a.m. The Guiding of the Fusiliers in the pitch darkness and heavy rain was most ably performed by this officer and men Sent as Guides, the task was a difficult one, and considerable fire had to be passed through during the relief. The Battalion billetted at MAZINGARBE the last Coy arrived in Billets about 2.0 a.m, No I Coy having been left behind to dig a trench in the 1st Line just North of HULLUCH. The Casualties today were 1 N.C.O Killed and 10 N.C.O's and men Wounded	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 1st 1915.	The Battalion had all arrived back in their billets at MAZINGARBE by 5.45 AM & the day was spent quietly in billets the Bn being on orders to be ready to move at half an hours notice.	Reference Maps - FRANCE 36B & 36C 1/40,000 & Trench Map 36C NW 1/10,000.
6 PM	LT H. MONTGOMERY & a draft of 42 N.C.O's & men arrived this afternoon making the Bn ten men over strength. The C.O attended a Conference at Divisional Hqrs at LABOURSE when the question of transferring officers from one battalion to another in order to make good casualties was discussed. This Bn was ordered to send five officers & the C.O discussed the subject with C.O. 2nd Bn after the conference Bn Hqrs & Brigade Hqrs are sharing the same house & met as late last night the 12th Division took over what would have been Brigade Hqrs & there was not time to make any other alteration.	
October 2nd	The Bn remained at MAZINGARBE all day. 2/Lt GRAYLING-MAJOR went sick this day & was sent to hospital so the C.O decided to only send four officers to 2nd Bn & the Guards Division was so informed. The order authorising	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 2nd (cont) 2 PM	this transfer appeared in tonights disseminat orders The CO & Adjutant attended a conference at Brigade Hqrs after the Brigadier talked about future operations & a contemplated attack on the HOLLUCH QUARRIES & informed us that the brigade would be moving forwards back to the trenches The C.O afterwards saw Company Commanders & explained the situation to them.	
October 3rd	Sunday Mass & Church of England services were held in the morning. In accordance with last nights dissemnat orders the following officers left the Bn to join the 2nd Bn to take up their new duties & to make good casualties in the 2nd Bn Temp Capt D.S.N FITZGERALD to take over duties of Adjutant 2nd Bn. LT R RANKIN LT H MONTGOMERY 2/LT L LANGRISHE. Captain L.R HARGREAVES took over command of No4 in place of Capt FITZGERALD & LTS CHRISTY was transferred to No4 Company.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 3rd (cont)	The C.O Captain T. M. O BAILLIE & all company commanders rode over to VERMELLES in the morning to see the trenches to be occupied by the Bn tonight. Company commanders returned after seeing where their companies would be while the C.O with Capt BAILLIE & O.C. No 4 went forward to reconnoitre the trenches to be held by the brigade which are in the old German front line. A guide showing the C.O round Sergeant of the K.R.R was killed while doing so owing to the party having to get out of the communication trench owing to a block	
2.10 PM	The Bn under the command of the Adjutant left MAZINGARBE	
3 PM	& marched to Vermelles in artillery formation arriving about 3 PM. The Bn was bivouacked in trenches west of railway & to N.E of VERMELLES about G 8 B central. The Bn is in Reserve to the Brigade. 2nd Grenadiers are to be in support trenches & the Old British front line north east of CHAP DE NOTRE DAME DE CONSOLATION. The 2nd 3rd Coldstream being in the five trenches in Old German line from G 12 A 54, inclusive to the WINDMILL G 12 C 87, inclusive. The ~~first~~ 3rd Coldstream on the right	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 3rd cont.	as far as ST ELIE AVENUE G11 B2.8. Brigade Hqrs were at G8 B10.4. The 3rd Guards Brigade were on left of our Brigade & the 2nd Guards Brigade were in ~~front~~ reserve at VERMELLES the 2nd Bn left Guards are therefore quite close. Two companies were out digging during the night.	
October 4th	The Bn remained in ~~front~~ reserve were responsible for cleaning up & improving all trenches to the front as far as the support Bn & parties were working on these all day. During the day there was a great bombardment and infantry fighting on our left front round the HOHENZOLLERN REDOUBT. One man wounded this day	
October 5th	The Bn remained in reserve trenches during the day, reliefs are the front line trenches from 2nd Bn Coldstream Guards as soon as dark. The Adjutant went up to arrange with O.C. 2nd Coldstream in making a Company Commanders went up with the C.O. in afternoon to be found by daylight & await arrival of companies. These are first bombing post in the line & there were	

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October 5th (cont)	also taken over by daylight by the company Commdrs.	
	LT H O'BRIEN was also sent up with four Bn bombers to	
5.30 PM	see their bombing posts & arrange for the holding of them	
	The Bn under command of Adjutant left reserve trenches at	
	5.30 PM to carry out the relief & went up by following communication	
	trenches CHAPEL ALLEY FOSSE WAY & LAMBORO HEAD. It had	
	been a wet afternoon & trenches were in bad state with deep	
	mud. Relief was therefore very slow, & it was very dark.	
9.30 PM	Relief was completed	
	Three companies are in the front line zone in support.	
	No 2 on the right from Point 54 G 12 A 54 (C U of AVENUE	
	in BRESLAU AVENUE; No 3 from that point to G 11 B 7.8 &	
	No 4 from there to ST ELIE AVENUE. On the right of No 4	?L
	were the 1st Gordons who relieved 3rd Coldstream. No 1	
	was in support in Old German front line between BRESLAU	
	& ST ELIE avenues.	
	One man wounded today.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 6th 1915.	The night passed off without incident a certain number of bombs being thrown from sap heads. No 2 has one sap head at point 54: No 3 two unimportant sapheads about point 78 No 4 two main sap heads one of each trench running up to point 90. During the night two platoons of No 1 were sent up to dig a new fire trench in front of No 3 Company's front of the line & so cut off the right angle at the VEE of PRESLAU AVENUE.	
12 noon	The Brigadier came round the trenches & made some suggestions for holding them. During the day there was a certain amount of shelling & sniping. Up to general work in deepening the trenches & making better fire positions was done on with. A great deal of work has to be done. For the right there are two trenches close together the forward one of which was used as a communication trench & the back one as a fire trench. As the parapets could not be made thick enough it was decided to make front trench into fire trench. Two men killed & three wounded.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 7th	The night passed off quietly & a great deal of work was done. The ground is very chalky & therefore digging is hard. Secret instructions were received during the night about the trenches had to be got ready for gas cylinders & instructions then to make the necessary cuttings were sent up. These cuttings were began by the two left front line companies at day-break	
8 AM	The Brigadier came up & gave further instructions	
	A party of 187th Field Company R.E. were shown round the trenches	
6 PM	The Bn was relieved by the 9th Battalion about 6 PM & proceeded to the Old British Front line which is the position of the Rn in support. Coys O & I were in Actual front line with No 3 in next line & No 4 behind again. No 1 was sent out to dig a new trench running north & parallel to SPOON HEAD which is a communication trench joining up Old	
7 PM		

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 7th (cont)	Brit's front line & old Germ. front line. The men had to dig in often & there was a constant stream of bullets from HOHENZOLLERN REDOUBT. 2/Lt R. H. HEARD was wounded while superintending this work	
12 midnight	No 1 Company was relieved by No 3 who carried on with work in the trench till 4 A.M.	
	Casualties this day one officer 23 men wounded.	
October 8th	The Bde remained in the support trenches. The clothes of the Bde in support are to be at all trenches from them up to the front are in good order & that all bomb & SAA stores are full & when necessary carry stores up to front Bns. The CO & Adjutant went round the trenches & allotted the work. While they were away a shell landed in the door of headquarter dug-out & knocked out BAILIE the only occupant at the time from the table where he was writing into the corner. No damage was done except Everything	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 8th (continued)	was covered with dust & the sun very blown in. The whole of the support trenches & the Bns in the front line were heavily shelled from 11.30 A.M. to 5 P.M. & this bombardment grew in intensity. During the afternoon the Germans attacked the 2nd 13th Bde ~~Guards~~ Coldstream Guards & the trenches occupied by the 3rd Brigade on our left. This attack was repulsed by 2nd 13th Bn Coldstream Guards with heavy losses but the Germans succeeded in gaining a trench from 3rd Grenadiers on our left as 0 & 3rd Grenadiers report most of his bombers had been killed. The bombers of No 1 Company were taken up to his assistance & did good work. The 3rd Coldstream organized a successful bomb attack & gallantly regained the lost trenches. Both	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 5th (cont)	Bns Coldstream & Grenadier Guards here urgently in need of bombs & the Bn sent up many boxes to each of them as well as boxes of SAA & ck so as to keep them constantly supplied. No 1 Company on the left held SPURN HEAD trench in case the Germans broke through & so defend the left flank of our Brigade.	
10.30 PM	The Brigade Major reported all was normal & quiet & that the Germans had been repulsed everywhere with enormous losses. The Bn then carried up rations for both Bns of Coldstream	
	A draft of 30 men arrived from the Base this day. Casualties this day six men killed & 12 men wounded of whom one was gassed by a German gas shell. During the night companies worked at the communication trenches which had been badly blown in in many places.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 9th 5.15 PM	Work was continued on communication trenches & refilling of bomb stores The Bde moved off to relieve the 2nd Coldstream in the right front trenches. Little work had been done in them since the Bde left owing to the attack yesterday on which the trenches themselves had been blown in in many places. Information was received from the Brigade that no gas would be used in these trenches so Company Commanders were told to fill up the recesses that had been to gain. Companies are in the same formation as that held 5th & 7th with exception that No 1 is now on right & No 2 in support. General improvement of trenches carried on with. Casualties this day five men wounded	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 10th	The night passed quietly except for a few bombs & one or two aerial torpedoes	
6 AM	Capt M. V. GORE-LANGTON was looking over the parapet at Point 54 on right of our line trying to select a position for a loophole when a sniper shot him through the head entering just his brain. He never regained consciousness & died about an hour later. He was carried down to the British Cemetery at VERMELLES and buried by Capt PONSONBY chaplain to the Brigade at 12 noon. The Bn has lost by his death one of its most capable respected officers. The command of No 1 Company was taken over by LIEUT YERBURGH. Capt BAILIE attended the funeral.	
12 noon		
12 noon - 1 PM	Shortly after 12 noon the right of our line was heavily bombarded by aerial torpedoes which made a tremendous noise & did great deal of damage as they landed in the trenches. The trench was blown in in several places.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 6th (cont.)	During the whole day the Intelligence were working in front of the QUARRIES at about 150 yards distance from our trenches. Owing to the long range at which the guns have to fire several shells dropped that all day but the Observation officer states that they prevented us later & that the work could not have been done extremely well. A German aeroplane was brought down this morning just behind our lines. Neither the driver or observer were hurt & both were taken prisoner. Brigade Report Centre was bombed from an aeroplane during the night & prevented enemy repairing their wire. Casualties this day one officer & five men killed & five men wounded.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 11th 1915	A great deal of work was done during the night & the new trench in front of centre company is now fit for occupation & is now held. The artillery during the night dropped one or two shells short & one damaged our one machine gun near G 11 B 7 8. The gun had to be removed but luckily no one was hurt. The artillery continued to break wire during today & several shells fell short making it most unpleasant for them in the front line on the left.	
12 Noon	The enemy started bombarding the trenches of our right company with several torpedoes blowing the trench in in some places.	
1.30 PM	A shell landed in the door of the Headquarters dug-out at 1.30 PM just at the end of luncheon. The C.O., Father Gwynn (Capt Bailie, Medical Officer & Adjutant were present at the time. The C.O. had both his legs badly broken & also wounds in the leg. Father Gwynn was severely	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 11th Contd	was seriously wounded in the back a piece of shell going through his lung as well as several other wounds. The Adjutant got a small wound in his foot but was able to remain at duty. The Medical Officer Capt Bailie escaped untouched. The C.O. Father Gaynor were at once arrested & with the greatest difficulty carried down by stretcher to Hqrs of Suffolk Regt where they were left till dark & then taken on over land. Captain Lord Desmond FitzGerald being the senior officer left took over command. The Bde Head Qrs then kept they would not be relieved until two or three nights by 35th Brigade	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 11th (cont) 4.30 PM	About 4.30 PM the Germans started shelling the left of our line with aerial torpedoes doing great damage to the trenches & wounding several men. It seems very difficult to discover when they are fired from but it appears to come from about point 70 in QUARRIES & some point N E of and QUARRIES This aerial torpedoing of the left of the line continued again after dark the Germans sending up a red light from their nearest sap & the torpedo fell shortly after a green light is seen. The Artillery got the range very well & they were eventually stopped by our heavy guns. A company of Pioneers coming up to dig new trench but were stopped by the aerial torpedoing there being a few in the distance & no working parties started up. Casualties this day besides officers 13 wounded & 3 killed.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 12th	After about 11 PM last night the night passed off quietly. General improvement & completion of trenches was gone on with & trenches are now ready to hand over in good condition. During night 120 scaling ladders were brought up & put in position in front trenches for the use of 35th Brigade when they attack tomorrow. Gratings & tins were put upon the back parados of our trenches so that artillery can aim when they	
8 PM	Capt Rev Father John Gwynn died in Hospital of Bethune from his wounds received yesterday. The Bde has lost truly not merely their Chaplain but a man universally beloved. No words could express the esteem & good he has done the Bde since he came to it last November & his death is deeply & universally regretted by all ranks.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 12th (cont)	In the afternoon the Germans shelled a certain amount doing damage to trenches & communication trenches.	
4 PM	The Germans made a bombing attack on the 2nd Grenadiers on our right about 4 PM but were driven off. Several boxes of bombs were brought up by our supply company, distributed & sent to them.	
5.30 PM	The R. was to be relieved by 7th R. Norfolks & guides met at VERMELLES CHURCH at 5.30 PM. Relief was very slow & was not completed till after midnight. Our company officers came up in course of afternoon & the bombing posts were taken over by daylight.	
	Casualties this day one man killed & 5 wounded.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 17th 1 AM	Relief was completed & Bn left trenches to march back to billets at VERQUIN. Companies ordered to form up companies in VERMELLES & march back by companies. The C.O owing to his wound had to be carried out of the trenches part of the way on a sitting stretcher.	
6 AM	N.C.O's & men were very tired after having had nine long & anxious days in the trenches. The Bn was not all back in billets till 6 A M & all ranks needed a rest. The rest of the day was spent	
10 AM	quietly in billets. Father Gwynn was buried at Bethune at 10 A M this morning & part of eight men were sent from 2nd Line. A list of all N.C.O's & men as well as officers to be rewarded was sent to Brigade office.	
	No casualties this day.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
October 12th 9 AM	Father Knapp came over from 2nd Bn & held Mass for the Bn & spoke to the men on the subject of Father Gwynn's death. There was also a Church of England service at the same hours. The Bn remained in billets at VERQUIN all day. Captain Lord Desmond Fitzgerald had to go to hospital this day to have a piece of shell removed from his foot. He received this wound on Oct 11th when the CO & Father Gwynn were wounded. The command of the Bn therefore devolved on Capt T. M. D. BAILIE who took Capt L R. HARGREAVES as his adjutant & LT HON H. O'BRIEN took over command of No 4 Coy.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 15th 4.45 pm.	The 1st Bn Irish Guards moved ~~from~~ to SAILLY-LA-BOURSE from billets at VERQUIN and arrived at their new billets at 6 pm. The 2nd Bn Grenadier Guards also moved into billets at SAILLY-LA-BOURSE ——— The 2nd Bn & 3rd Bn Coldstream Guards moved into VERMELLES.	
Oct 16th	The Battalion spent the day in resting in billets at SAILLY-LA-BOURSE. During the afternoon the Men were paid.	
Oct 17th 4 pm	In the afternoon the Battalion moved into VERMELLES and took over billets occupied by the 2nd Bn Coldstream Guards.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct. 18th	The Battalion remained in billets at VERMELLES during the day. These billets consisted of houses entirely shattered by shell fire. A great deal of work was done in making them as habitable as possible and in making shelters and proper cover for the men. Drill Sergt Weekes arrived this day.	
Oct. 19th	The Battalion moved from VERMELLES to occupy Trenches (reserve) in front of CLARK'S KEEP. These Trenches were handed over by the 1st Bn Welsh Guards.	
Oct. 20th	The day was quiet and free from shelling. The time was spent in cleaning up and making light overhead cover for the men against rain.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct. 21st	In the morning the Commanding Officer and One Officer per company inspected the trenches occupied by the 2nd Bn Coldstream Guards with a view to taking over. At 4 pm the Bn moved up into these trenches. There were no dug outs in the line and a party under Drill Sergt Cahill worked during the night in erecting a sand bagged cover for Bn H.Q in the old British 1st Support line.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 22nd	Major Hon H.R. Alexander this day took over command of the 1st Bn weather fine. Work spent in improving the trenches — making dug outs etc. No 4 coy continued work on a new sap (KAISERIN SAP) No 3 working towards no 4. Work was slow owing to the difficulty of exposure — the earth was shovelled into sandbags and emptied at night. Much of the day was confined to sniping and a little trench mortar throwing by the Germans. During the day the Bn suffered 5 casualties — 3 were caused by our own shells falling short. In the afternoon an old German communication trench was discovered running from BIGWILLIE towards a German sniping post.	 Ref 1.5000 G. 5 A 2.0 The above free hand sketch shows line held by the Bn from Oct 22nd — Oct 26th Trenches held by 1st Bn in red except SAVILLE ROW. those in blue by GERMANS.
7 pm	During the night excellent work was done in KAISERIN SAP. No 4 coy joined up with the 3rd Bn Grenadiers	
4 am oct 23rd (~~night~~)	on ~~our~~ our left (2nd Bde) at 4 am (oct 23rd). The remainder of the sap was continued no 4 coy and no 3 coy each doing about 15 yds. No 4 coy put out French wire and chevaux de frises about 15 yds in front of the new sap. The night was very bright, but the	
1 am oct 23rd	wiring was completed at about 1 Am when it got misty	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
2 Am.	A patrol from No 2 coy under Lt Durant went out to reconnoitre this newly discovered trench. They found the trench filled in from our parapit for about 8 yds when it then ran clear to the German barricade about 60 yds from BIG WILLIE. A wire tangle was placed about 35 to 40 yds in the trench from our own line to form an obstacle, with a view to breaking down our own parapit and placing a barricade and bombing party near the wire, the next night.	
2.30 am Oct 23rd	At an arranged time signal lights were sent up at our new sap head, the Grenadiers conforming to ascertain our relative positions with a view at a later date of bombing the Germans from their sniping post and joining up so as to shorten our line	 rough sketch show where light signals were sent up by 1st 1 Gds & Grenadiers on night of Oct 22nd marked A. B. Also where wire tangle was put out marked C. German British

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 28th	weather still very fine. Sapping in KAISER IN SAP was still continued but slowly the trench being dug straight without traverses, in order to get the line completed as quickly as possible. Firing steps were made as the work progressed and at night this new fire trench was manned, in case of an attack. In BIG WILLIE, on the left of our line, an old traverse was broken down and a new one built about 30 yds from the barricade. This was loopholed and a Lewis gun placed in position. 2 pm. The Germans blew in our sap head in BIG WILLIE with a minenwerfer, doing considerable damage to the trench and burying 7 men and injuring 5 (Total 12) The new loopholed traverse was so destroyed that the Lewis gun had to be withdrawn and another loopholed barricade made 15 yds further back. Owing to the fire from the minenwerfer work had to be discontinued during daylight.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
3.30pm	Relieved by the 2nd Bn Coldstream Guards. No 1 & 2 coys were relieved from the front line and returned to trenches near the SHRINE at VERMELLES No 3 & 4 coys took over the support trenches from the 3rd Bn Coldstream Guards The whole relief was completed by 5.45 pm. One casualty — one man hit in the thigh during the relief, in the communication trenches. Total casualties during the day Killed — 7 Wounded — 6 Total 13.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 24th 8.30 am. 11.30 am. 5.15 pm.	Day commenced fine, turning to rain in the afternoon. Father Knapp said mass at the SHRINE at 8.30 am. 2nd Lieut Levy arrived with a draft of 58 men, 1 S/sgt and 2 corporals. The men were posted to the different companies to make up their strength as equal as possible. 2nd Lt Levy was posted to No 4 company. A fair lot of men, but did not look too well drilled. About 6 had been out before. The day passed quietly except for a few shrapnel shells which burst near VERMELLES Church. 12 steel helmets were issued per company. Church of England service was held in the cellar of the Chateau* in the evening.	* this chateau is famous for the amount of fighting, counter mining which took place in Dec 1914 between the French and Germans.

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 25th	Reveille at 6.30 am Breakfast at 7.30 am	
9 am	No 1 and 2 coys relieved no 3 and 4 coys in the support line.	
1 pm	Rained hard the whole day. The C.O, Capt T.M. Baillie & Capt W.H. McCarthy, m.o. left VERMELLES to attend the funeral of the late General Hon. J.S. Tnefusis which was held at WINDY CORNER, GIVENCHY. Capt Blake was left in command.	
6 pm	The Germans again burst shrapnel shells near the SHRINE, but no damage was done. 2 casualties were reported from the "rest line", caused by a dug out falling in, owing to the wet. The men were admitted to hospital suffering from bruises.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 26th 11.30 am.	Day fine and bright. 11.30 am the Norfolk Regt arrived at Bn H.Q. to relieve 1st Bn. No 3 & 4 coys relief were completed by 12 noon. These two coys marched independently to SLAG HEAP, where they closed up and were joined by H.Q. and the transport. This party under the C.O marched via BÉTHUNE — AINAZIN — LABEUVRIÈRE to billets in LAPUGNOY arriving in at 4.30 pm. No 1 & 2 coys were relieved by 2.30 pm and marched under Capt T.M.D. Baillie by the same route arriving in at 7.45 pm. 3 platoons from no 3 coy and 3 platoons from no 4 coy were put under canvas owing to the shortage of billets. Fresh straw was provided for the whole Battalion and teas were served out on arrival in billets. Water here not fit for drinking purposes — so water carts are filled at MARLES. Blankets arrived at 12 midnight but were not issued.	Fosse No 9 de BÉTHUNE

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct. 27th	Reveille 6.30 am Breakfast 7.30 am adjt orders 11 am Cs orders 11.30 am. Rained the early part of the day, but later the weather cleared. The whole day was spent in cleaning up and getting the men themselves cleaned. Note coy was taken from under canvas and put into a big building which is used as a theatre. In the afternoon the Battalion was paid. The Brigadier came to Bn H.Q in the afternoon. 2nd Lt D. Longworth was sent off to hospital this day.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 28th	Reveille 6.30 am Breakfast 7.30 am Battle orders 9 am Coys orders 9.30 am. The day was very wet.	
10.30 am.	The Bn paraded with 104 coy leading and marched to CHOQUES so as to meet the remainder of the Brigade at 12 noon. Dress — ~~Drill order~~ marching order with kit packs — Officers revolvers and ~~swords~~ sticks; all ranks carried rolled oil sheets or macintoshes. This parade was for inspection by His Majesty the King, who was to review the Guards Division at HAUTE RIEZE at 3 pm.	
12.30 pm	The order was given to return at once to billets as the review had been cancelled owing to an accident to the King.	
1.45 pm.	The Battalion arrived in billets. Dinners were served out immediately on return.	

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Hour, Date, Place	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Oct 29th 10 am.	Reveille 7 am Breakfast 8 am. Weather dull but no rain. The Bn paraded under company arrangements. One hours steady drill was done and the remainder of the morning was spent in inspections of kits, deficiencies etc. Lists of deficiencies were given into the Quarter Master, with a view to replacing losses, and articles worn out etc.	
10 am.	At 10 am the Commanding Officer went round the billets and inspected billets, latrines etc. shops, Quarter masters stores. The billets are fairly good and dry. Everything was clean, latrines and refuse pits well dug.	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LAPUGNOY	Oct 30th		Day fine and clear.	
		7 am	Reveille 7 am	
		8 am	Breakfast 8 am.	
		9 am	Mass 9 am	
		10.30 am	Bn paraded under company arrangements for one hours steady drill. Arrangements were made for training 2 officers and 4 extra men per company in the Lewis gun. This short course to last 4 days when another squad of 2 officers and 4 men per coy would be trained. Sec Lieut Levy was put in charge of the Lewis gun section. Sec Lieut Levy and Lieut Law commenced their training this day. Lt Adm H.B. O'Brien started a new squad of bombers, training as many men per company as possible in the Mills bomb. 20 boxes of mills were put aside for this purpose.	
		2 pm to 3 pm.	Lewis gun lecture to new squad.	
			New clothing was issued to companies.	
			No 3 coy were moved from under canvass into billets at the S.W. end of LAPUGNOY.	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LAPUGNOY	OCT. 31ST		Reveille 7 am Breakfast 8 am weather dull and rainy ~~All Saints day~~ — men went to all church services voluntarily. Communion 7 am mass 8.45 am Benediction 3 pm Father Knapp preached at the parochial mass held at 11 am. Church of England service was held at 10.30 am near the Grenadiers' Head Quarters. The Band of the Grenadiers attended at this service and played.	

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1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

WAR DIARY

1st BATTN. IRISH GUARDS.

N O V E M B E R

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LAPUGNOY	NOV 1st		Reveille 7 am Breakfast 8 am weather very wet. All Saints day — church services the same as sunday. Parade was ordered for 10 am to be under the Sergeant-Mayor — young officer to have instruction in saluting under the Drill Sgt. Owing to the wet all parades were cancelled. Adjt orders 11.30 am COs orders 12 noon The Lewis gunners paraded under cover and had 1½ hrs lecture 1/8th company held a concert in their billets during the afternoon.	
	NOV 2nd		Rained hard the whole day Reveille 7 am Breakfast 8 am. all parades had to be cancelled owing to the wet. Captain Blake was sent to hospital suffering from influenza. At 4 pm Lt Colonel R. C. McCalmont arrived to take over command of the Battalion.	

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5,090 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LAPUGNOY	Nov 3rd		Reveille 7 am Breakfast 8 am The day broke beautifully fine The Battalion paraded at 10 am for an hours steady drill. Lewis gunners and Bombers paraded separately for special instruction in their different branches of speciality. During the morning the CO. inspected all billets, shops, stores etc Adjts orders at 11.30 am. COs orders at 12 noon In the evening a Battalion concert was held in the Theatre to which the Curé and Major Ryan R.A.M.C of 16th F. C. Hospital were invited. The programme was entirely local talent and proved a great success. During the afternoon Colonel McCalmont proceeded on 5 days leave spent to London. The Quarter master left here at 1 pm with 2 NCOs and 2 Pioneers from No 1 coy to make the necessary arrangements about Captain M.V. Gore-Langtons grave in VERMELLES. This party arrived back at 1 am.	

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5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LAPUGNOY	NOV 4th		Reveille 7 am Breakfast 8 am Adjts orders 11.30 am Cos orders 12 noon. The weather was misty but fine. No 1 coy paraded at 9.45 am and proceeded to the Brasserie where 20 tubs and an unlimited supply of hot water was provided for the men to bathe in. This company was finished by 1 pm. No 2 company was given the hours from 2 pm – 5 pm. Each company bathed 60 men per hour. No 3 and 4 coys carried on with steady drill under the Sergt Major. 2nd Lt Holmes was given special instruction in drill under D.S. Cahill.	
	Nov 5th		Day dull and showery. Reveille 7 am Breakfast 8 am No 3 and 4 coys spent the whole day in bathing — same hours as No 1 & 2 coys. No 1 and 2 coys paraded in marching order without packs at 9 am and route marched from 9 am — 11 am. Adjts orders 11.30 am Cos orders 12 noon.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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WAR DIARY
or
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Army Form. C. 2118

3,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LAPUGUGNOY	Nov 6th		Reveille 7 am Breakfast 8 am. Day fine and sunny No 3 and 4 coys paraded at 9 am and route marched from 9 am – 11 am No 1 and 2 coys paraded under company arrangements at 10 am Bombers and Lewis gunners paraded separately for special lectures and practical instruction under Lt. O'Brien and Lt Levy respectively. 2/Lt. D. Fitzgerald commenced his course of instruction in the Lewis gun. At 5 pm rum was issued to the men in the form of "toddy" – with hot water, sugar, lemons and cloves. This was highly appreciated.	

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Army Form. C. 2118

5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 247/15.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LADIGNY	NOV. 7th		Reville 7 am. Breakfast 8 am Mass at 8.45 am in the parish church. C of E service was held in the school at 9.15 am by the Chaplain	
	NOV. 8th		Weather fine Reville 7 am — Adjt orders 11.30 am Breakfasts 8 am — COs order 12 noon The Commanding Officer arrived at LADIGNY at 3 am. Parade 9 am All companies route marched from 9 — 11 am Order — marching order without packs. At 5.30 pm the band of the Grenadier Guards gave a concert in the theatre, lasting for 2 hours.	
	NOV 9th		Reville 7 am. — Adjt orders 11.30 am Breakfast 8 am — COs orders 12 noon The CO inspected all companies on parade between 9.30 am and 11.30 am Boys paraded in full marching order The afternoon was spent in cleaning up.	

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Army Form. C. 2118

5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LAPUGNOY	NOV 10th		Reveille 7 am Breakfasts 8 am The Battalion paraded at 9.15 am, marched off and joined up with the remainder of the Brigade at CHOCQUES. The Bde marched via HINGES to PACAUT and PARADIS. The Bn billets were at PACAUT which we reached at 3.30 pm The morning was very wet but it cleared in the afternoon. The billets were not bad, but very scattered.	
PACAUT	NOV 11th		Reveille 6.45 am Breakfasts 7.45 am Mass was said by Father Knapp in PARADIS church to which about 300 men went. The Bn paraded under company arrangements at 10 am Adjt's orders 11.30 am Cos orders 12 noon The day throughout was beautifully fine	

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Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
PACAUT	NOV 12th		Day very wet. Reveille 7 am Breakfasts 8 am All parades had to be cancelled owing to the weather. Mass was held in PARADIS Church at 8.45 am by Father Knapp to which a large proportion of the men went. Adjts orders 11.30 am Cos orders 12 noon.	
PACAUT.	NOV 13th		Very wet and windy. Reveille and Breakfasts at the usual hour. Mass was held at PARADIS at 8.45 am. and in spite of the weather a number of men attended. Orders as usual. Parade for companies at 10 am In the afternoon the CO and Capt Alexander rode over to 2nd Bn at LA GORGUE.	
PACAUT.	NOV 14th		Reveille 7 am Breakfasts 8 am. Mass 8.45 am C of E at 11 am in No 3 coy billets At 2.15 pm the Bn paraded and marched into fresh billets on the Northern outskirts of MERVILLE arriving in at 3.30 pm The billets were good, but again very scattered.	

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Army Form. C. 2118

3,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MERVILLE	NOV 15th		Reveille 7 am. Breakfasts 8 am. Companies paraded under company arrangements at 10 am. Adjts orders 11.30 am Co's orders 12 noon. The weather very fine. About 12 noon Lord Desmond Fitzgerald arrived and ~~[illegible]~~ resumed over the duties of adjutant. In the afternoon the men were paid. The Battalion heard the news of Lt Col Maddin's death, which occurred rather suddenly in London on 12th inst., after he was believed to be over the worst.	
MERVILLE	NOV 16th		Battalion Drill - 2 men wounded (one seriously), during Lewis Gun instruction. Capt. Hon. H. Alexander returned to 2nd Batt. Battalion remained in billets - Weather fair but cold.	
MERVILLE	NOV 17th		Route marches by Half Battalions and a party — mostly young soldiers — had lecture and demonstration of use of smoke helmets in Gas. Weather turned very wet. Frost at night.	

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5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MERVILLE	Nov 18th		Companies paraded for Company Drill. Batt.n remained in billets. Band of the Grenadier Guards gave a concert for the Batt.n and the 2nd Bn. Coldstream Guards in a Hall in the town in the evening	
MERVILLE	Nov 19th		Company parades for Steady drill, & Kit inspection. 5 platoons had baths in the town. The four Lewis machine Guns were allotted one to each Company, in accordance with orders.	
MERVILLE	Nov 20th		Batt.n moved to Reserve Billets about BOUT DEVILLE in the afternoon, taking over from 1st Bn. Scots Guards. Also took over two posts behind the line, in the neighbourhood of ROUGE CROIX.	1:40000 Map Sheet 36A & 36. M. 27
BOUT DEVILLE	Nov 21st.		Remained in Billets. Batt.n attended Mass and Church of England service. Lieut. T. E. Nugent transferred from 2nd Batt.n, & took over duties of Assistant Adjutant, Capt Lord Desmond Fitzgerald (Adjutant) being second senior in the Batt.n	

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Army Form. C. 2118

5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
In trenches. NEUVE CHAPELLE.	Nov 21st	11-0 a.m.	Major General Cuny the Division inspected the Batn + the 2nd Batn, accompanied by Sir John Redmond MP, the Irish Nationalist Parliamentary Leader : Both Batns being in line on the road.	
	Nov 22nd	5.0 p.m.	Batn took over line of trenches from 2nd Bn. Grenadier Guards, from M 35 a 8.2 to M 30 c 0.3. No 3 RIGHT, No 2 CENTRE, No 1 LEFT + No 4 in Batn Reserve. Trenches — practically all breast works — in very neglected state, except for work done by 2nd Guards Brigade + 2nd Bn Canadian Guards during previous week. Much sand bagging necessary. Very wet in places — second line almost non-existant, + in many places impassable through wet. Enemy very quiet, + in most places his trenches more than 100 yds distant. No communication trenches available, so relief took place by roads. Casualties — 3 wounded. Batn Head Quarters at EBENEZER FM (M 34 b 5.9) Arrangements were made to allow men to leave small articles (any socks &c) in bags, with the Qr master, when going into trenches. Leg trench boots were also issued to about half the Batn from Store near the line : their own ankle boots being kept for them in the case of one leg.	Sheet 36. 1·40000

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Army Form. C. 2118

3,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
In trenches NE of NEUVE CHAPELLE.	Nov 23rd		Batn in trenches as on previous day. Enemy quiet — weather fine — a good deal of work done. No 1 Coy unlucky with casualties (rifle bullets). Casualties — 5 wounded (1 died of wounds) + 2 killed.	
	Nov 24th	10-0 am	Field guns bombarded & knocked down about 20 yards of Enemy's parapet on extreme RIGHT of Batn, & there was very little retaliation — none on our trenches.	Map Sheet 36 1:40 000
		5-pm	Batn relieved by 2nd Bn Grenadier Guards & returned to Reserve Billets about RIEZ BAILLEUL (very scattered). Relief rather slow: nos 1 & 2 Coys late in reaching billets. Casualties — 3 wounded.	
RIEZ BAILLEUL.	Nov 25th		Batn in billets. Arrangements to concentrate billets all on to one road. Inspection of billets by Co. No 1 Coy occupied newly built wooden huts.	

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3,000 — Imp. dec A. C. — 24/7/15.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
In trenches NE of NEUVE CHAPELLE	NOV 26th		Immediately after dark, Bath took over same line of trenches from 2nd Bath Grenadier Guards, as on 24th inst, with an extension to LEFT. No 1 Coy went into Support trenches (Bath Reserve), No 4 Coy going on the LEFT of the line, which extended to M 29 b 5.0. Weather turned very cold, but bright & hard frost. Enemy quiet. Still much work necessary to make trenches habitable.	Sheet 36 1:40,000.
	NOV 27th		The Major General (accompanied by the Prince of Wales) inspected the whole line held by the Bath. Weather continued frosty. A steel cupola discovered in enemy's first line opposite our Left Centre was fired at by our guns but remained practically undamaged. Day & night otherwise quiet. Casualties – 1 Killed, 2 wounded (1 died of wounds).	
	NOV 28th		Bath holding same line. Our artillery fired at two places in enemy's wire opposite our centre coy, also bombarded same cupola as on previous day, & (with only slight damage), & an enemy Blockhouse. Retaliation very slight. Casualties – 3 wounded (2 by our own Shrapnel). Relieved by 2nd Bn Grenadiers after dusk: & returned to former billets at RIEZ BAILLEUL	

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5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15.

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
RIEZ BAILLEUL	Nov 29th		Batt. remained in billets in wet weather Inspection of billets by Co. & Conference of officers in evening	
RIEZ BAILLEUL	Nov 30th		Batt. took over same line from 2nd Bn Lancashire as on 28th inst. No 2 Coy in Batt. Reserve, No 1 going into the Centre. Small breach in parapet just outside our Right made by enemy shell, was repaired without interference a quiet night.	

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1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

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1st BATTN. IRISH GUARDS.

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Page 1

5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15

Place	Date 1915	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
In trenches NE of NEUVE CHAPELLE.	Dec 1st		Batt. occupied same line of trenches as on previous day - Further shelling of cupola opposite centre Coy, without effect = day otherwise passed quietly. Casualty — 1 wounded -	
	Dec 2nd		a quiet day except for slight shelling by enemy which did no damage - 1st Guards Brigade relieved by 3rd Guards Brigade - Batt. handed over to 4th Batt Grenadier Guards after dark, and went into billets as Divisional Reserve at LA GORGUE (L.34 d 2.7) Relief of Centre + Left Companies was very slow owing to returning Companies not arriving in order arranged, + No 4 Coy did not reach billets till after midnight. Casualty 1 killed. The line handed over had been considerably improved during the 12 days, as regards the front parapet, many thousands of sandbags being put in: but all communication trenches still full of water, + all reliefs by SIGN POST LANE + SUNKEN ROAD overland. Heavy rain following frost caused many collapses of breastworks -	Sheet 36a. 1:40,000.

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Army Form. C. 2118

5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 347/15

Place	Date 1915	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LA GORGUE	DEC 3rd		Batn billetted in the town - weather very wet. Inspection of billets by CO : 3rd Bn Coldstream also Brigade + Div. H.Qrs in the town.	
"	4th		Baths for all companies : parades for steady drill. A Recreation room + concert room opened for the troops in the town -	
"	5th		Mass in the Church, + Church of England service (with Band of the Grenadiers) in the Concert room -	
"	6th		Remained in billets - weather very wet. Company Drills.	
"	7th		Same as previous day - C.O. reconnoitred new Trenches, + had Conference of officers in the evening.	
"	8th		Marched at about 1.15 pm, to relieve the 2nd Batn of the Regiment, in trenches. Relief took place just before dark, as road safe from observation led to within 500 yds of front line. Line taken over extended from N 13 b 3.2 to N 8 c 9.9, just E of PICANTIN, + parallel to RUE DE TILLELOY.	sheet 36 1:40000.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Army Form. C. 2118

A.690 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15.

Place	Date 1915	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches near PICANTIN	Dec 8th (contd)		Batn Hd Qrs at the RED HOUSE a large farm less than a mile behind the trenches, hitherto untouched by enemy's guns (M 6 d 1.1). All 4 companies in the front line, except for 3 posts about 250 yds in rear, holding a platoon each — in order 1, 2, 3, 4 from the LEFT. German line nearly 400 yards away on the LEFT narrowing down to about 45 yards at "RED LAMP" on the RIGHT, where the line ran back at right angles with two "fish-tail" pieces of trench parallel to the alignment. Ground wet in the parapets breastworks, but on the whole a more comfortable line than the one previously held, about 2 miles further SOUTH. The enemy were very quiet throughout the 24 hours, and the Batn retired to billets at the end of that period at LAVENTIE, in order to avoid two Batns relieving on the same night. Casualties — NIL.	Sheet 36 1:40,000
LAVENTIE. LE TILLELOY	" 9th 10th		In billets in the town of LAVENTIE, except for 3 posts garrisoned by a platoon each in the second line of defence. A company 16th S.B.R. Welsh Fus[rs] (also C.O. + Rajtant) arrived to be attached for 8 days instructions, & they were distributed through the Batn. Inspection of billets by CO. Weather still wet but warm. A draft of 25 joined from 7th Lancs Fusiliers Regt.	

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Place	Date 1915	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches near LE TILLELOY and PICANTIN	Dec 11th		Took over line of trenches, disposition as on 9th inst. 1st Battn being strengthened by 1 Company 11th R. Welsh Fusrs. Relief completed immediately after dusk. A portion of the Right Company's line was evacuated owing to fear of an enemy mine near the parapet, which our mine was endeavouring to counter. A quiet night, without casualties	
	Dec 12th		A further portion of the line held by No 4 was evacuated to enable 9-2 gun to fire on suspected enemy mine shaft: fire was not very effective, but our 18pr destroyed an enemy pump in their parapet. Lt Christy with a patrol, through a pierced notice in German wire entered their lines, advising them to surrender. 2nd Lt Law with a patrol met two German patrols & had some difficulty in getting back. Enemy artillery retaliated on RUE TILLELOY between our trenches & our Battn H.Qrs, but were otherwise very quiet. The only casualty was an accidentally self inflicted one.	
	Dec 13th		Another very quiet night: we had patrols out, & a listening post saw an enemy patrol. We report that enemy trenches can hardly be properly held especially on the LEFT, & they are evidently very wet. 9-2 fired again with more success: enemy retaliated again but not seriously: 4 men wounded (1 by our own 9-2, & others by enemy shrapnel). Returned to billets at LAVENTIE after dusk, except for usual 3 platoons in Reserve posts.	

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Army Form. C. 2118

3,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15.

Place	Date 1915	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LAVENTIE	Dec 14th		In billets at LAVENTIE. weather colder & brighter.	
	15th		mass & a Church service before the usual drill parades. Took over same line at dusk : dispositions as before. Lieut Law on patrol, located a German party in a dug out & having returned, went out again with a larger party with a view to taking prisoners. Dug out was found to be large, built of concrete with bunks in it & large loopholes for machine gun : no Germans seen, but trenches & the dug out itself full of water. Party was challenged but not fired on when returning about midnight Casualties - Nil.	
Trenches near LE TILLELOY	16th		An exceptionally quiet day & night, the Germans having evidently abandoned their front line for the time being, holding a second line only, owing to wet. All offensive action being temporarily suspended by Divisional order, further steps against the dug out discovered on the previous night were suspended. No casualties.	
	17th		The line still very quiet. Relieved by 2nd Bn Grenadiers at dusk, & returned to billets at LAVENTIE. Casualties - Nil, except one attached R. Welsh Fusilier killed. A draft of 50 joined from the Grand Rutrenching Batt.	

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Army Form. C. 2118

5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/715.

Place	Date 1915	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LAVENTIE	Dec 18th		A quiet wet day in billets. The usual cleaning-up. CO, Adjt & Coy 16th R. Scots Fus^rs left, & were replaced by a Coy 14th R. Scots Fus^rs	
	19th		Mass in temporary Church & Church of England Service in the Railway Station Shed. Some shelling in a portion of the Town which did not affect the Batt^n. Took over the same line at dusk - dispositions as before. Fine bright moonlight night: rather quiet. One man wounded.	
TRENCHES near LE TILLELOY	20th		It had been intended to blow up the enemy's concrete dug-out found & reconnoitred by Lieut Law on the 15th inst, & a selected party from No. 1 Coy under Lt Law, with an officer & 4 men 15th Coy R.E. were prepared, but the night was exceptionally light all through - at about 5.0 a.m. an advance patrol was sent out to reconnoitre but found the enemy at work, & were fired on by their covering party. As it was near daylight & unnecessary risks had been ordered to be avoided the C.O. cancelled all arrangements. The day was quiet, & after dark the line was handed over to the 4th Bn Grenadier Guards (3rd Guards Brigade) who were an hour late in arriving. 5. that Companies were late in returning to Div^l Reserve billets at LA GORGUE. Casualties — 2 men wounded; + Lt-Col E. F. Christy slightly wounded in ear.	

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5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15.

Place	Date 1915 Dec	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
LA GORGUE	21st		In billets. Usual cleaning up & preparations for Christmas	
	22nd		In billets. Drill parades & Bombing & Lewis Gun instruction. Lecture for officers in the evening, on 1657-8 Campaign.	
	23rd		Baths were arranged for the whole Batt. at La Gorgue. 2nd Lieuts C.R. Starkey & P.J.P. Rodakowski joined from 7th Guards Entrenching Batt.	
	24th		Drills & instruction for Bombers & Lewis Gunners.	
	25th		Said by Father Murphy Mass in La Gorgue Church at which the Band of the Grenadiers played. Church of England service with 2nd Bn Coldstream in Convent room. Christmas dinners in billets, including Roast Pork & French Beer provided from Regimental funds: the C.O. & other officers went round the dinners as at home. The Quartermaster was able to arrange for the cooking to be done in a large bakehouse. C.O. Adjutant & 2 other officers lunched with 2nd Batt. Hd Qrs in Brigade Reserve billets at PONT DU HEM.	
			Major Gen. the Earl of Cavan saw all the officers in the evening & in announcing his appointment to command the XIV th Corps, paid a high compliment to the Batt. of which he said "there might be as good, but there are none better" in the Division. He was very sorry, he said, to leave the Division, but told the officers that there was just a hope that the Div. might go to his Corps.	

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5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 247/15

Place	Date 1915	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
In trenches N of NEUVE CHAPELLE	26th Dec.		After voluntary Services, marched about 2.30 pm to take over the RIGHT Sector of the Division's line, as previously occupied by the Batt[n] during November :- from SIGN POST LANE (N. of NEUVE CHAPELLE) to M 29. a 6.9 - Relieved 1st Bn Scots Guards (2nd Guards Bde). Companies take the line as follows :- two 2 on RIGHT, 1 in CENTRE, 4 on LEFT & 3 in Support (including posts). Enemy exceptionally quiet & did not indulge in Retaliation. Practically no rifle or machine gun fire. No casualties.	
	27th		Enemy still very quiet, but the trenches in a very bad state as regards wet & mud, & the parapets in many places very bad - a Company 10th S. Wales Borderers ordered to be attached. Casualties Nil.	
	28th		Enemy snipers had resumed their normal activity this morning, but the day was otherwise quiet. The combined efforts of 3 officers at Battalion Hqrs with revolvers, resulted in the killing of a pigeon, which was carrying an old British message. Relieved by 2nd Bn Grenadier Guards at dusk, & returned to Rest billets at RIEZ BAILLEUL without any casualties - 2 platoons bring in posts at ROUGE CROIX.	

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Army Form. C. 2118

5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15.

Place	Date 1915 DEC	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
RIEZ BAILLEUL.	29th		C.O. inspected billets, the same as previously occupied. Lieut C.S.R. Hanbury to Hospital with "French Fever".	
Trenches N of NEUVE CHAPELLE.	30th		After usual morning drill, took over same line of trenches in the evening from 2nd B.G. Guardsmen. No 3 on the RIGHT, 2 in Centre, 4 on the LEFT, No 1 in support. A quiet night: no casualties.	
	31st		Some shelling of No 4's trenches in the morning, and indiscriminate shelling on other places throughout the day, including a direct hit on Bde H.Q. dug-out, which did no damage. The enemy started on our RIGHT a heavy burst of Machine gun & rifle fire at about 11-0 pm (presumably nearly midnight with their time) to celebrate the New Year: this continued for about 20 minutes & we were lucky not to have many casualties in the Nos 3 & part of 2. Casualties – one killed.. one wounded:	

R McCalmont
Lt Col
Comdg 1st Bn Irish Guards.

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WO 95/
1216

1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

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1st January 1916

Place	Date 1916 Jan	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches N of NEUVE CHAPELLE	1st		A very quiet day after the enemy's outburst of the night. Relieved by 2nd Bat Grenadiers in the evening, & returned to usual billets. Casualties: — 2 wounded, also our man employed at Brigade Bomb Store.	
RIEZ BAILLEUL	2nd		Usual Mass and Church of England Services. Appointment of the Brigadier (Brig Gen G. Fielding DSO) to command the Guards Division, vice Maj Gen Earl of Cavan CB MVO appointed to command a new 14th Corps, was announced in orders.	
Trenches N. of NEUVE CHAPELLE	3rd		Batt: took over same line of trenches in evening, no 2 Coy in support, remainder in order 3, 1, 4 from RIGHT. Usual sniping & some shelling: one man wounded.	
RIEZ BAILLEUL	4th		Major Lord Desmond Fitzgerald assumed command, vice Lt Col McCalmont proceeding on leave. Batt: unexpectedly relieved by 2nd Bat Grenadiers & returned to billets at RIEZ BAILLEUL in the evening, owing to a relief by a fresh Brigade having been ordered & to square the roster between Batts. Casualties — 3 men wounded.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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WAR DIARY
or
INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY
(Erase heading not required.)

Army Form. C. 2118.

2.

5,950 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15

Place	Date 1916 Jan	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
ST. FLORIS	5th		1st Guards Brigade relieved by 114th Brigade, & proceeded to neighbourhood of CALONNE. The Batns marched in the afternoon to billets at ST. FLORIS, being relieved in Reserve billets by 10th Batt Welsh Regt. New billets were taken over in very filthy condition.	(Sheet 36a (P. 6.a.
"	6th		Usual routine, & inspection of billets by CO. Father Knapp said Mass in ST FLORIS Church (The Epiphany).	
"	7th		Drill under Company arrangements, & usual routine.	
"	8th		Usual routine, also training of young NCOs under Drill Sergts. Undetonated bombs issued to Companies for throwing practice.	
"	9th		Usual Mass & Church Services. Scheme of training issued to Companies to enable training of NCOs, Bombers & Lewis gunners to be carried on without interfering with Company Drill parades	
"	10th		Company Route marches & other training. Lecture by AA & QMG Guards Div. on "Supply", at CALONNE, to officers.	
"	11th		Route marches for 2 Companies & other training. Brig General C. E. Pereira assumed command of 1st Guards Brigade	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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WAR DIARY
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(Erase heading not required.)

Army Form. C. 2118

3

5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 347/15

Place	Date 1916 Jan.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MERVILLE	12th		Batt. moved to billets NW & W of MERVILLE in the morning, taking over from 1st Bn S. Lancs Regt (56th Brigade)	36 A K27 b3.8
"	13th		Usual routine in new billets. Lieut Hon H.B.O'Brien appointed Brigade Bombing Officer	
"	14th		Major Lord Desmond Fitzgerald proceeded to London to attend Investiture, & Capt T. M.B. Bailie assumed command. Draft of 45 arrived from 1st Bn S. Lancs Regt.	
"			Usual routine and baths.	
"	15th		Usual Training, routine & baths.	
"	16th		Companies marched to Mass in MERVILLE Church. Church of England service at Batt Hd Qrs.	
"	17th		Route marches for 2 Companies, & usual routine. Major Lord Desmond Fitzgerald returned in the evening, & resumed command.	
"	18th		Company Route marches & training	
"	19th		Usual Company Drills & other training &c.	
"	20th		C.O. inspected Nos 2 & 3 Coys : route march for remaining companies.	
"	21st		Inspection of Nos 1 & 4 Coys by C.O. Route marches & baths for remainder.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

WAR DIARY
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INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY
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Army Form. C. 2118

4

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3,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24775.

Place	Date 1916 Jan	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MERVILLE	22nd		Usual routine (Training & baths).	
RIEZ BAILLEUL	23rd		1st Guards Brigade ordered to relieve 115th Brigade in the line previously occupied at the beginning of the month. The Batts moved in the morning, & took over billets at RIEZ BAILLEUL, the 2nd Bn. Coldstream also moving, both Batts being attached to 115th Bde.	Sheet 36 1/40,000
CHAPELLE D'ARMENTIERES	24th		Batts took over line of trenches as on 4th inst, from 4 Batts Welsh Regt. Companies in order from RIGHT (SIGN POST LANE), 3, 2, 1 : 4 in Support. The line was found to be in good order & situation normal except for a new crater recently formed by one of our defensive mines just in front of DUCKS BILL = an officer had been lost there a night or two before, & it was necessary to dig a sap out to it. There was some grenade fighting : casualties - 2 NCOs & men wounded.	36 SW 1 1/10000
Trenches - N. of NEUVE CHAPELLE	25th		Situation normal, but a good deal of Sniping & some rifle grenades near DUCKS BILL. a little shelling on the LEFT. Casualties - 1 Corporal (Barker) killed - 3 men wounded. Lt Col R McCalmont returned off leave, having been detained in London in connection with Compulsory Service Bill in House of Commons, and resumed command. 1st Guards Bde H.Q. relieved 115th Bde.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Army Form. C. 2118

5.

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Place	Date 1916 Jan	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches RIEZ BAILLEUL	26th		A quiet day except for rather more sniping than usual. Batn returned to billets at RIEZ BAILLEUL in the evening, being relieved by 2nd Batt Grenadiers. Casualties – 4 NCOs & men wounded.	
	27th		In order to equalise the Roster, Batn returned to trenches & relieved 2nd Bn Grenadiers – No 3 on R, 2 in Centre, 4 L & 1 in Support. A quiet night except for snipers. Casualties – 2 wounded.	
Trenches N of NEUVE CHAPELLE	28th		A normal day, except for Grenades on DUCKS BILL. ~~Brigadier visited line for the first time since assuming Command.~~ Trench mortar Battery caused some retaliation. Casualties ~~(Killed at DUCKS BILL)~~ one wounded.	
	29th		Just after midnight, Captain V.C.J. Blake was killed by a stray bullet, while pointing out wiring work for his company (No. 2). The Brigadier came round the line for the first time since assuming command. DUCKS BILL situation rather unsettled & responsible for casualties, which amounted altogether to 1 officer ~~killed~~ & 2 other ranks killed, 2 other ranks wounded (1 died of wounds 12/1/16); ~~& 1 man accidentally wounded while employed under Brigade Bombing Officer~~. Batn relieved by 2nd Bn Grenadiers & returned to Reserve Billets at RIEZ BAILLEUL in evening.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Army Form. C. 2118

16

3,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15

Place	Date 1916 Jan	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
RIEZ BAILLEUL	30th		Father Knapp said Mass in the Open air. The Archbishop of Armagh (Primate of All Ireland) visited Batn., lunched at H.Q. Mess & held a service afterwards, before going to another Service for the 2nd Batn. at ZAVENTIE.	
Trenches N of NEUVE CHAPELLE.	31st		After usual Company Drills in morning, Batn. took over usual line of trenches in evening from 2nd R.S. Fusiliers — No 3 on R, 1 in Centre & 4 on Left - 2 in Support. A quiet night. — No casualties up to midnight, except one man accidentally wounded, while employed with Bujadi Bombers.	

R. McCalmont
Lt Col
Comdg 1st Bn. Irish Guards

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

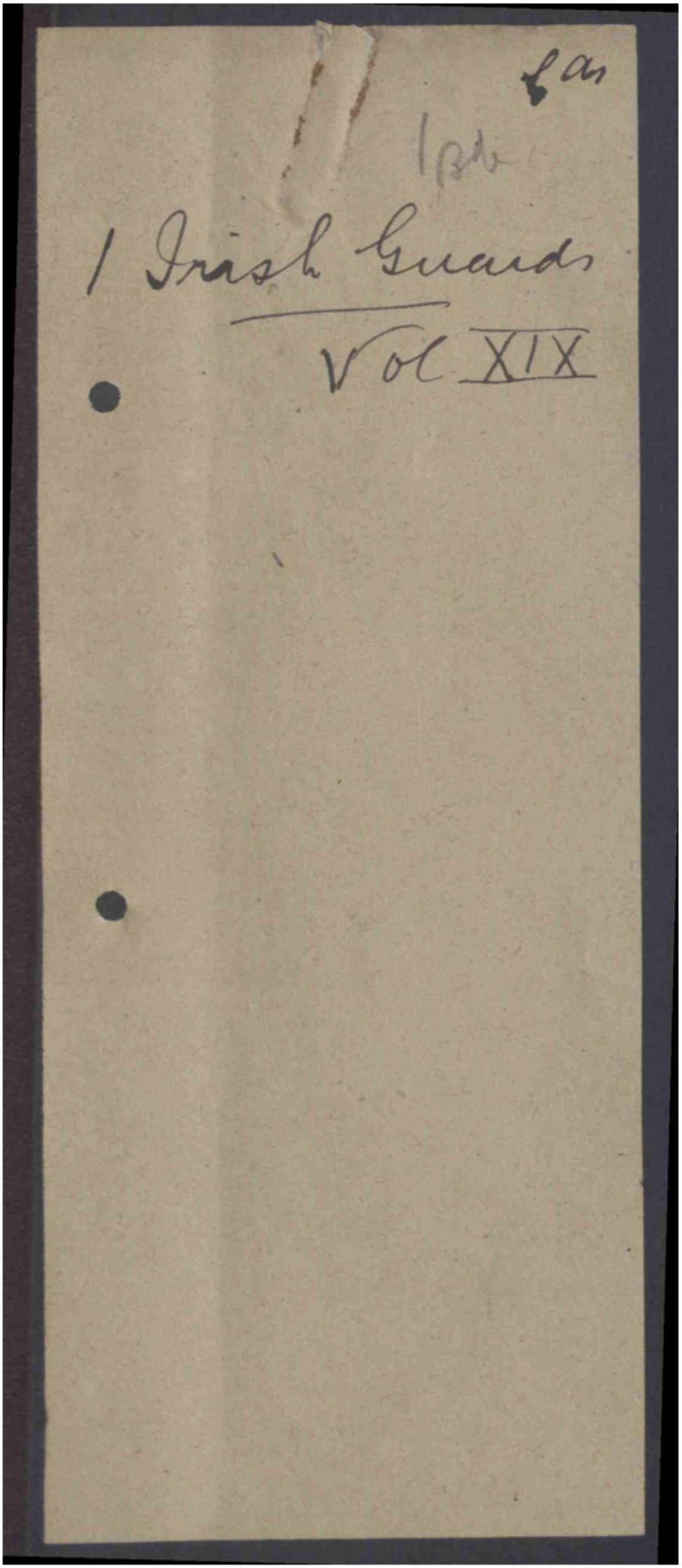
1st Guards Brigade.
Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

FEBRUARY 1 9 1 6

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1



The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Army Form. C. 2118

(1)

Place	Date 1916 Feb.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches N of NEUVE CHAPELLE	1st		At an early hour, the one mine-shaft in the DUCKS BILL, held by no 3 coy, was suddenly flooded, drowning 2 Coldstreamers in a listening-post. This was probably due to natural causes, but resulted in considerable doubt as to the advisability of holding the BILL itself. Otherwise quiet. Casualties – 3 wounded – (one died).	
	2nd		A quiet night & morning. Pumps failed to make any impression on the water in the mine-shaft, & work was started to provide better protection & head cover for those in DUCKS BILL & NECK. no Casualties. Returned to Reserve billets in the evening, on relief by 2nd Bn Grenadiers. Major Hon RCS Chichester joined the Battn from home, & took command of no 2.	
RIEZ BAILLEUL	3rd		Usual routine in billets. It had been intended to blow up enemy's wire into ammonal tubes, by a party from every Battn on this night = Lieut Law had a patrol trained, but the enterprise was abandoned owing to the disappearance of one of the Sappers concerned, while on a reconnoitring patrol.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form. C. 2118

(2)

5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 247/15.

Place	Date 1916 Feb	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches N of NEUVE CHAPELLE.	4th		Took over same line of trenches from 2nd Bath Grenadiers in the evening, & found everything very quiet. No 3 Coy in Support, No 2 taking over the RIGHT, with Nos 1 & 4 as usual. No casualties during the night.	
	5th		A normal day except for wire-cutting in 3 places on our front by Artillery, 250 rounds being fired at each place. There was some retaliation, & we were lucky to have no casualties as a result. Enemy very quiet through the night, despite our machine gun fire on the gaps in the wire. Casualties 2 wounded.	
	6th		Prince Albert breakfasted at Bath H.Q., being out on a short tour from England. After a very quiet night & day, Bath handed over to the 2nd Bath Grenadiers in the evening, it being understood that the Division would shortly move out of this part of the line. No casualties. Returned to billets at RIEZ BAILLEUL.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Army Form. C. 2118

(3)

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5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15

Place	Date 1916 Feb	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
RIEZ BAILLEUL	7th		Batts moved to billets immediately SOUTH of MERVILLE - Batt Hd Qrs in the town just N of the Canal. Companies somewhat scattered to the S. + S.W., but comfortable -	
MERVILLE	8th		Usual routine for first day in new billets + inspection by the Brigadier. A large number of officers proceeded on leave during the last few days, owing to an anticipated stoppage of leave after 20th inst.	
"	9th		Major Lord Desmond FitzGerald resigned the Adjutancy owing to his seniority requiring him to be second in command, and proceeded on leave - Lieut. J. E. G. Nugent was appointed to the vacancy from this date -	
			Usual drills + training of Bombers : Lieut. Hawkey taking on Bombing Officers duties.	
"	10th		In addition to usual Training, Officers + some NCOs attended a most interesting lecture on the battle of Neuve Chapelle, given at LA GORGUE by Brig Gen Anderson (GSO1, 8th Div. during the action). The Drums have made considerable progress, + play Retreat + Tattoo daily both in Billets.	

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Army Form. C. 2118

(4)

Place	Date 1916 Feb.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
MERVILLE	11th		H.M. Earl Kitchener (Colonel of the Regt) inspected the 1st Guards Brigade on parade, just outside MERVILLE - A pouring wet day, & a wait of over an hour - The actual inspection was very brief, but the Batns were wet through -	
"	12th		Usual routine in very poor weather - 500 men went to La Gorgue baths - Draft of 25 recs & men arrived from Entrenching Batn - The Band of the Coldstream gave a most successful concert for the 3rd Bn Coldstream & 1st Bn Irish Gds, in Merville: and all the officers of the Batn dined at the Hd Qrs mess.	
"	13th		Mass in Merville Church said by Father A. Knapp OP, who preached a farewell sermon, having been ordered to proceed to 141st Brigade - Church of England service in a Marquee - Baths at Lafoyer -	
"	14th		Usual routine in billets & short Company Route marches. Brigade Hd Qrs & the 2 Batns still E of Merville, moved to N.W. in preparation for move. Rev. P.J. Lane-Fox, C.F. arrived from 1/London Irish for duty with the Batn vice Father A. Knapp who left to take up the same appointment.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Army Form. C. 2118

(5)

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5,000 — Imp. des A. C. — 547/15

Place	Date 1916 Feb.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
EECKE	15th		Batns marched with remainder of 1st Guards Brigade to EECKE (about 2 miles S. of STEENVORDE), in expectation of remaining there for about a week. about a 12 miles march. Orders were however received while on the march, to continue to move Northward next day. Billets were fairly good but very scattered, on roads East of EECKE (where Batn H.Q. were).	
in POPERINGHE	16th		Batns of 1st Guards Bde marched independently to Camps W & NW of POPERINGHE. Another 12 miles, in worst possible weather, a hurricane wind and rain. Batn Camp was situated about ¼ mile S of the main YPRES – POPERINGHE – DUNKERQUE road, 3 miles from POPERINGHE = & was fortunate in being connected to the main road by a metalled lane. About 250 men were in tents (mostly blown down), remainder in huts of various patterns, the whole round a farm & connected by floor-boards to keep out of the deep mud. all officers messed in one hut = the first Batn mess for some time. As a result of the previous day's move, the Brigade came into the 2nd Army area, & into the 14th Corps under the command of Lt Gen Earl of Cavan.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form. C. 2118

(6)

Place	Date 1916 Feb.	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
'N' Camps, near POPERINGHE	17th		After C.O.'s inspection of the camps, the Corps Commander visited it - He explained that the 1st Guards Brigade had been somewhat hastily brought up North, owing to a small German offensive on the Left front of the Corps, which holds the Left of the whole British Army. It was however understood that it was unlikely that the Brigade would be required except to hold the 3rd line in the event of a German success - Brigade H.Q.rs at POPERINGHE were placed direct under the 14th Corps for Tactical purposes - German aeroplanes passed over camps during the night, both Poperinghe & Hazebrouck being raided.	
	18th		Routine in camps as far as possible as at home - Fife & drum calls used, & the usual afternoon Batn. parades - Being pay-day, & only 6 men per Coy being allowed in POPERINGHE, stores & beer were purchased from the Field Force Canteen, and retailed in camps -	
	19th		Usual Company parades & training -	

A.999 — Imp. des A. C. — 24/7/15.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Place	Date 1916 Feb	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Camp 'N' near Poperinghe	20th		Father Lane-Fox said mass in a wood near camp. Church of England Service in Camp. Major Lord Desmond Fitzgerald returned off leave, & took over duties of Second in command. Batt'n team played against 2nd Bn. Grenadiers, & was beaten 3-0 after a good game. Battalion Drill on ground which soon cut up. Otherwise usual routine. Weather turning very cold — An inter-platoon bombing competition was started, & lasted several afternoons.	
	21st			
	22nd		Usual routine of Company work & bombing: also testing Snipers rifles. It began to snow, following on frost.	
	23rd		In addition to usual routine, officers & a party of men attended a demonstration of a German "Flammenwerfer"; to prove the harmlessness of the flame close to the ground. Heavy fall of snow, & bitter cold weather.	
	24th		Usual routine: bitter cold continued with snow on the ground. 4 German aeroplanes appeared over Camps about noon & dropped 3 bombs within a few hundred yards but without doing damage. Hostile aircraft appear to have superiority in this area, being active almost daily, especially at Poperinghe.	

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Army Form. C. 2118

8

Place	Date 1916 Feb	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
In POPERINGHE	25th		Weather if possible colder. Usual routine. It had been expected that Batn would move to Calais, but only 2nd Bn Grenadier + 3rd Bn Coldstream did so. Camp was taken over by an offr from 2nd Batn of the Regt, preparatory to a move during the night. Transport marched at 10-0 pm, having a longer route.	
CALAIS	26th	1-0 am	Batn marched in bitter cold, with snow on the ground. The roads were in the worst possible condition for marching, the beaten snow in the centre being like ice + necessitating marching on the sides of the road most of the way. Slow progress was made, + 15 miles took about 7 hours, the Batn catching up the Transport at 8-0 am in CASSEL, where entrainment should have been complete by 8-30 am at BAVINCHOVE Stn. All entrained by 10-15 am except 3 baggage waggons which were held up on Cassel hills. Train arrived CALAIS about 1-0 pm, but no R.T. Offrs could be found till after 2-0 pm when detrainment had commenced. Arrived No 6 Rest Camp about 3.30 pm outside town on DUNKERQUE Rd. Whole Batn in tents = some snow still on ground.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Army Form. C. 2118

(9)

Place	Date 1916 Feb	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	27th		A quiet day in Camps after the severe march. Tents proved quite as warm as huts & an extra blanket was issued: the ground wonderfully sandy & dry. Mass said by Father Lane Fox in church just outside camp. Church of England service in camp. Passes allowed up to 25%, for Calais	
	28th		C.O. inspected camps, & also saw all Companies & Transport & complimented them on their march under very trying conditions. Made a start in Training programme: large area of ground in camp available for drill purposes — Batt. drills. Wet afternoon prevented a start in Bombing attack practice.	
	29th		Companies practised attack of trenches by bombing parties with proper organization: also Company drill. Weather improved.	

R. McCalmont
Major
Comdg 1/Bn Irish Guards

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

MARCH 1916

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

1 Irish Guards

Vol XX

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Army Form. C. 2118

(1)

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Place	1916 Date MARCH	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
CALAIS	1st		Routine of Training in Camps. A party of Officers from the Brigade was conducted round the various workshops, Depots &c at the Base.	
	2nd		Further training in Bombing Attacks &c, & Batn. Drill.	
	3rd		Batn. marched to the Beach for various forms of Training. During live bomb practice a Mills bomb exploded prematurely, as the result of which Major Lord Drumond Fitzgerald received many severe wounds, of which he died in about an hour at the Millicent Sutherland Hospital (No 9. Red Cross): Lieut & Adjt T.E.G. Nugent was dangerously wounded at the same time: the Rev. R.J. Lane Fox C.F. was wounded in the right eye & hand, & Lieut C Hanbury in the hand & leg. All were removed to the same Hospital with very little delay.	
	4th		Training continued - Captain (temp) A.F.L. Gordon assumes the duties of acting Adjutant: Major Hon ACS Chichester becomes 2nd in Command. A Court of Enquiry on the previous day's accident was held. Lieut & Adjt T.E.G. Nugent reported progressing favourably, as were the other 2 officers, although Father Lane Fox lost his eye & some fingers.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

WAR DIARY
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Army Form. C. 2118

(2)

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Place	Date 1916 MARCH	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
CALAIS	5th		Mass said for the Batt^{n} in Church near Camp, by Father Ryan: Church of England service in Camp. Major Lord Desmond Fitzgerald's funeral took place in the afternoon from the Hospital to the public Cemetery. In accordance with his own request there was no formal parade, but the whole Battalion lined the Graveside road - The Brigadier & representatives of the local French Commandant, French Navy & Belgian army attended -	
	6th		The Batt^{n} moved early by rail, under Major Hon H.C.S. Chichester, the Commanding officer remaining at Calais in connection with the previous day's funeral - Lieut K.W. Hogg remained in Hospital, sick. Rail to BAVINCHOVE (CASSEL), thence by march route to WORMHOUDT = Batt^{n} H^{d} Q^{rs} in the SOUTH end of the town, Companies being in farms further South & somewhat scattered - There was a heavy fall of snow. Rev. F.N. Brosse S.J., C.F. joined the Batt^{n} for duty, from G.H.Q.	Map. Sheet 27 1/40000.
WORMHOUDT.				

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

WAR DIARY
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Army Form. C. 118

(3)

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Place	Date 1916 MARCH	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
WORMHOUDT	7th		Continued heavy snow, which lay thick on the ground. Inspection of billets by the 2nd in command. The Commanding Offrs returned & resumed command in the evening.	
	8th		Heavy snow made further training impossible. Lieut Hon. P. Ogilvy joined Batn from the Entrenching Batn.	
	9th		Little training possible, beyond Bomb throwing. There was a Horse Show given by the Artillery of the Division a few miles away, at which officers competed.	
	10th		Lieut Count J. E. de Salis & 2nd Lieut D. J. Hegarty joined from the Base. Training only possible on roads: a thaw having set in. The final of an inter-platoon (25 a side) bomb throwing competition was held, no 5 Platoon beating no 10 Platoon.	
	11th		A party of French officers from 2nd Army H.Q.rs visited the Batn, & saw how Quartermaster's stores, also the Lewis Gunners & Batn Bombers, and the Batn at Rifle Exercises. They also saw the other Batns of the Brigade.	

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Army Form. C. 2118

(4)

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Place	1916 Date MARCH	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
WORMHOUT	12th		Father Brown said mass for the Batt: in WORMHOUT Church. Church of England Service in billets attended by 116 NCOs + men, a higher number than usual for a voluntary service: Conference at Brigade Head Quarters.	
	13th		Usual drill parades: great improvement in the weather.	
	14th		Companies route-marched to a rendezvous in exceptionally warm weather. Officers attended a lecture on Gas attack defence in afternoon.	
	15th		Usual Company drills & other parades. Brigade began to move.	
	16th		marched in the afternoon to Camp M, 2½ miles W of POPERINGHE between PROVEN & WATOU roads.	
Camp M, near POPERINGHE	17th		accomodation in huts & tents: a Batt: Officers mess in farmhouse. Major Hon RCS Chichester left to transfer to 2nd Batt, Capt T Bailey 2nd in command. St. Patrick's Day = Mass in the open, also a Church of England Service. weather excellent. The day was observed as a holiday, & a programme of Sports arranged on a neighbouring football ground.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Army Form. C. 2118

(5)

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Place	Date 1916 March	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Camps S near POPERINGHE	17th (cont'd)		A football match between the Flank & Centre Companies, followed by various athletic events comprised the programme, which lasted until a late special dinner. The Batt'n marched in the evening, through POPERINGHE to Camp A, about a mile WEST of VLAMERTINGHE, & just NORTH of the main road to YPRES. (H. 2 a). The Band of the Coldstream played in Camp M through the day & headed the Battalion through POPERINGHE which was full of troops. The Shamrock sent by H.M. Queen Alexandra in accordance with the custom was distributed by the Commanding Officer & worn by all ranks.	Sheet 28 1/40 000
	18th		The 1st Guards Brigade took over the RIGHT Sector of the Division's new front, E of YPRES, the Batt'n remaining in A camp in Brigade Reserve: camp composed of rough huts on muddy ground.	
	19th		Mass by Hall/Batt'n in large barn in camp - The Chaplain detailed for Church of England service failed to appear.	

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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WAR DIARY
or
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(Erase heading not required.)

Army Form C. 2118

6

Place	Date 1916 MARCH	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Camp A near POPERINGHE.	20th		The Major General inspected the Camp, which, although a lot of work had been done, was still in rather an insanitary state owing to dirty mud, refuse &c. C.O. went round the Trenches.	
	21st		Usual drill parades and cleaning up of camp. Gen. Sir H Plumer, G.O.C. 2nd Army paid an unexpected visit to camp. A coffee bar was established in the Barns, & with football & cricket (for officers) the camp was not too uncomfortable. Much aerial activity daily, & shells in VLAMERTINGHE, but none near camp.	
	22nd		One offr per Coy, & one NCO per platoon went to as an advance party to 2nd Bn Grenadiers in the trenches - Usual drill & training.	
	23rd		3 offrs & 25 Petty Officers R.N. arrived to go to the trenches with the Battn - The day spent in preparations for 4 day tour - Battn moved by rail, entraining at 8 30 pm at a siding ½ mile W of camp, & detraining at the ASYLUM, YPRES, where 2nd Bn Grenadiers met platoons.	

1875 Wt. W595/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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Army Form C. 2118

7

Place	Date 1916	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
In Trenches E of POTIJZE	MARCH 23rd (Contd)		Took over line from DUKE ST (I5a8·3) to FENCHURCH ST (C29a3·1) no1 Coy on R front to WARWICK FM (C29c6·3) : no4 L. Fusrs. no2 in Support E of POTIJZE WOOD and in CONGREVE WALK (E of ST JEAN) : no3 in Reserve on CANAL BANK immediately N of YPRES. Batn H.Q. in POTIJZE WOOD, just N of the Chateau. The Relief was carried out smoothly, except in the case of no1 Coy + Hqrs which were wrongly led down the MENIN Road to within about 500 yds of HOOGE, + were lucky to find their way back by about 1-0 a.m. without being even fired on — The same line of trenches which had been taken over by 2nd 3rd Guards in a very bad state, from 6th Divn. Only one communication trench possible, + that (HAYMARKET) a bad one = but the main road could be used after dark. Little or no work possible in daylight in front line, but the whole line was quiet except for some indiscriminate shelling. No casualties up to date.	Sheet 28
	24th	1-0 a.m.	Heavy snow in the early morning + during the day.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form C. 2118

(18)

Place	Date 1916 MARCH	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
POTIZJE	25th		A quiet day & night in the trenches : one man wounded by shrapnel on the canal bank. A thaw set in.	
	26th		Some shelling during the afternoon : one whizzbang into a small dug-out killing all three occupants - Lieut R. J. P. Rodakowski slightly wounded on ankle by small piece of shell. The line otherwise quiet, although there was considerable shelling on back lines. Casualties : {3 other ranks killed. {1 Officer wounded. The killed were buried by night at POTIZJE.	
In trenches	27th		An uneventful & quiet day, except for shelling round POTIZJE. Relieved by 2nd Bn. Grenadier Guards after dark - a very wet night, but a very good relief - Bath - all entrained at YPRES ASYLUM by 11-0 pm & returned to former A camps, detraining at a siding close to the camps - No further casualties. The Transport came up to POTIZJE on 3 of the 4 nights, & were lucky to escape casualties, as the roads are regularly shelled.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form C. 2118

(9)

Place	Date 1916 MARCH	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Camp A, E of POPERINGHE.	28th		Usual inspections in Camp after coming from trenches.	
	29th		Company drill parades & usual routine & cleaning & improving of Camps.	
	30th		Usual Company drills & training with Smoke helmets, dummy bombs, dummy ammunition &c. Mass for 2 Coys.	
	31st		Mass ~~& 8.0~~ for remaining 2 Coys, & Church of England Service. Batt[n] entrained at 7-20 pm for YPRES as on 27th inst, & relieved 2nd B[n] Guards by 10-30 p.m. No 2 on Right, 3 on Left, 1 in Support & 4 in Reserve. Considerable shelling on the roads during relief but no casualties. The line had been considerably damaged by shell fire, the front trenches S of the POTIZJE road being completely destroyed also DUKE ST, & quite impassable by daylight. ~~the~~ Routine as on 23rd-26th:- viz 50% of Coys rested for half day, & all worked through night.	
Trenches E of POTIZJE				

P. W. Calvert
Lieut. & Adjt. 1/13th Batt. Hussars

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

APRIL 1916

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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WAR DIARY
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INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY
(Erase heading not required.)

Army Form C. 2118

1 Inf Bde

Place	1916 Date APRIL	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches near POTIJDE.	1st		In same line of trenches (POTIJDE) - A quiet day - 2 NCOs + men wounded -	
	2nd		A normal day in the line = considerable progress made in reclaiming the demolished trenches on Right of line - Sergt Major Kirk accompanied by C.S.M. Carroll were severely wounded while coming through YPRES about 11-0 pm, returning off leave = Total casualties, of whom must were of this party 2 WOs wounded - one man killed, + 3 men wounded -	
	3rd		Sergt major Kirk died of his wounds at POPERINGHE, when he was being An uneventful day in the line but considerable shelling during relief by 1st Bn Grenadiers (3rd Guards' Bde) from 9-30 pm onwards. Bn returned to billets in POPERINGHE by rail from YPRES - Casualties — 8 men wounded -	
POPERINGHE.	4th		In billets at East end of POPERINGHE : excellent accommodation in Convent + other large buildings, for all ranks. Usual inspections during the day - A variety of Entertainments provided for all ranks — Cinema, Band Concerts, 6th Div "Follies" &c, in the town -	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form C. 2118 (2)

Place	Date 1916 APRIL	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
WINDSOR	5th		The Battalion was inspected by General Gilinsky (late Chief of Staff to the Grand Duke Nicholas of Russia), & marched past. He was accompanied by the Army Commander & the Major General. Other usual routine in billets.	
	6th		The C.O. commenced an inspection of all Companies in full marching order, with kit. Otherwise usual routine continued.	
	7th		Company inspections continued. Lieut. A.C.W. Innes joined the Battn & was posted to No 2 Coy.	
	8th		Further company inspections. Lecture on French mortars for all officers of the Brigade. The massed Drums of the Brigade (including also those of 2nd Battn Irish Guards), beat Retreat in the Square on most evenings.	
	9th		Mass in St Jean Church, & Church of England service with 2nd Bn Coldstream, in the Big Cinema Hall with Coldstream Band.	
	10th		Inspection of No 1 Coy completed the whole Battn. Lt Col McCalmont proceeded on Special leave to attend House of Commons. Lieut J. K. Greer (to No 1) & 2nd Lt T H Laycock (to No 4) joined.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form C. 2118

(3)

Place	Date 1916 APRIL	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
POPERINGHE	11th		Usual morning routine, including one of a series of lectures for Officers & NCOs on Gas Defence.	
		6.0 pm. to 7.0 pm.	The neighbourhood of the Batt.n's billets was unexpectedly shelled, several falling near Batt.n H.Q.rs & No 4 Platoon. Captain P. R Woodhouse RAMC (attached to the Batt.n) proceeded to attend to several casualties in a neighbouring house, assisted by Cpl Clayton (RAMC attached), both being wounded themselves. Captain Woodhouse hit in the shoulder, but insisted on remaining at duty.	
		9.30 pm	Batt.n (under Capt T.M.D.Bailie) left by rail for YPRES to relieve 2nd Guards Bde: H.Q.rs & one company in the Convent des Carmes: 2 companies in the Ramparts, & one in Rue de Malon: all below ground. No shelling during the move.	
			Casualties (in Poperinghe) - 1 officer wounded (at duty), 1 man wounded & 1 RAMC attd.	
YPRES	12th		Usual first inspection of billets by C.O.: they were very dirty, & work was immediately started to improve them, & to make a bath house. A quiet day.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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Army Form C. 2118

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Place	Date 1916 APRIL	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	13th=		Cleaning up of billets, & usual routine as far as possible under cover. Bath house completed.	
C1				
W	14th=		The Major General inspected the billets, & subsequently sent a special message of congratulation on the work done & improvements made.	
C				
C	15th=		In course of clearing up the Convent garden, an Irish Guards Star was made on the ground of colored glass & other materials from the ruins = about 4 feet in diameter.	
K			Lt Col McDermott rejoined at night & resumed command.	
Trenches near RAILWAY WOOD	16th=		Bath moved by Companies immediately after midnight 15/16th=, to relieve 2nd Bn Grenadiers at RAILWAY WOOD (NW of HOOGE), on extreme Right of the Division, & almost the most Easterly point of the Salient - a Canadian Division on our Right. No 1 Coy Right front = No 4 Left front (with its Left on Roulers Railway) = No 3 in Support (N of Railway) : No 2 in Reserve on road near "Hell-fire-Corner" where Railway crosses it. The Right of the Battn was about 250 yds N of the MENIN road.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form C. 2118 (5)

Place	Date 1916 APRIL	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
	16th (cont'd)		Bath. H.Qrs at RIFLE FARM, isolated during daylight. A quiet day, with considerable hostile aerial activity - 1 man wounded.	
	17th		Lt Col McCalmont again proceeded on special leave for Parliamentary purposes, Capt. (temp. Majr) Bailie being left in command. Brigadier inspected the line early in the morning. Some shelling on Reserve Company — 6 men wounded.	
	18th		A quiet day - 2 men wounded (one at duty). 2nd Lieut. J.W.A. Earle joined Bath. & was attached to No 2 Coy.	
	19th		Except for violent bombardments to both North + South, & an attack on WIELTJE + other places during the night — a quiet day. One man died of wounds.	
	20th		Relieved by 2nd Bn Grenadiers at about 3-0 am, & the Bath. returned to its former billets in YPRES. Daily fatigue parties were furnished by the Bath. nightly during its 16 days tour = the other Reserve Bath. of the Brigade being in Camp near VLAMERTINGHE.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form. C. 2118

6

Place	Date 1916 APRIL	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
YPRES	21st		A quiet day in Ypres = companies keeping under cover in daylight	
	22nd		The same. A bath house made by the Bath^n at the convent was a great success.	
	23rd		A similar day, untoward incident. Three were large fatigue parties each night.	
	24th		Bath^n relieved 2nd B^n Grenadier Guards in same line of trenches (RAILWAY WOOD), marching at midnight. Companies disposed as follows :- No 2 Right front, No 3 Left front, No 4 in Support - No 1 in Reserve -	
Trenches near RAILWAY WOOD.	25th		A fairly quiet day, but a fatigue party carrying R^E material under Lieut T. K. Walker was badly shelled near the Railway wood itself, Lieut Walker being killed, and several other casualties. Total for the day — one offr + 4 men killed, 7 wounded (of whom 2 died). Captain P. R. Woodhouse (M.O.) went forward to this party, having to cross the open under fire from shells + aerial torpedoes to do so. A quiet day in the same line - No casualties.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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Army Form C. 2118

(7)

Place	Date	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Trenches near RAILWAY WOOD	26th		Another quiet day except for a certain amount of nightly bombing & firing of rifle grenades on the Left front. Casualties – 2 other ranks wounded.	
	27th		Batn was relieved at night by 1st Batn Grenadier Guards (3rd Gds Bde) after a quiet day, proceeding by rail from Ypres Asylum in 2 trains, one at 11-30 pm & one at 1-0 a.m. One man was wounded. A quiet relief, and the Batn reached "Camp C" in the wood at A 30, about ½ mile N of Ypres – Poperinghe road. A comfortable camp of huts & tents among the trees, the weather having turned very warm.
Camp C, near POPERINGHE.	28th		Lt Col Rhodes-Wood returned & resumed command in the evening.
	29th		There was a gas alarm from the 5th Division several miles South about 1-0 a.m, the alarm horns &c being distinctly heard, but the Batn was not roused. A quiet day was spent, under Company Officers' arrangements.

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Place	Date 1916 APRIL	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Camp C, in Poperinghe	30th		A few large shells from a newly arrived 15 cc gun were dropped in the immediate neighbourhood of the Camp in the early morning, without however doing damage. Father Browne said mass in the open air, & Church of England service was held in a neighbouring Church Army Hut. The Batt.n Team beat the York & Lancasters at football in the evening.	

R. McCalmont
Lt Col
Cmdg 1st/3rd Lish Guards

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

1st Guards Brigade.

Guards Division.

1st BATTALION

IRISH GUARDS.

MAY 1916

The National Archives reference WO 95/1216/1

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form C. 2118

1 Irish Guards (1)

Vol 22

Place	Date 1916 MAY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
Camps C & POPERINGHE	1st		Batt: resting in 'C' Camps, about 2 miles E.N.E of POPERINGHE.	
	2nd		Usual routine while at rest.	
	3rd		Weather very close & hot.	
	4th		Batt: drill in 3 coys, in addition to usual Company routine. Lecture by GSO3 at Bde: H.Q on "Intelligence", more especially in improving our methods in the Division.	
YPRES	5th		Moved by rail from neighbouring siding to YPRES, into Brigade Reserve = 2 Batts: being in the line, & one back in Camps B. Batt: H.Q & No 3 in the Prison = Nos 1 & 2 in the Magazine across the road from the Prison, & in neighbouring cellars - No 4 in dug outs along the "Dry ditch" behind the prison.	
	6th		As much drill as possible was done, especially in the Prison which was practically intact, & there was ample room in the main corridor. There was heavy shelling of Ypres & surrounding roads from 8.0 pm through the night, causing considerable casualties - No 1 Coy on a digging fatigue had 4 men wounded.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.

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WAR DIARY
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Army Form C. 2118

(2)

Place	Date 1916 MAY	Hour	Summary of Events and Information	Remarks and references to Appendices
YPRES Trenches near WIELTJE	7th		Father Browne said Mass in the Prison & in the Magazine - Church of England Service in Prison Basement. 2 Platoons employed on a night digging fatigue. Some shelling at night.	
	8th		A normal quiet day.	
	9th		After a normal but very wet day, the Bath relieved 2nd Bn Grenadier Guards in the left Sector of the Brigade at night: this was the sector occupied by the 2 Coldstream Bath of the Brigade in March, but they had much the worst time. Later the change. Did not move till after 11-0 pm, & took over a very disjointed line, no 3 Coy being on the Right, from C 29 a 3·2, just S of WIELTJE to the village itself inclusive, his Left being "in the air" & consisting of bombing-posts only, owing to a bombardment in April. No 1 held the Left Front considerably further back, from the WIELTJE road (inclusive) about C 28 a 9·2, joining the 6th Div. about C 28 a 4·8. No 2 in Support, in trench running N from the same road at C 27 d 8·5. No 4 in Reserve in ST JEAN and a post at LA BRIQUE. Bath HQ in a dug out at the back of HASLER HO in ST JEAN.	Sheet 28
			Lt C. R. TISDALL joined the Batt from Entrenching Bn. Lt K. E. DORMER left for duty with 7th Sdn Entrenching Batt.	

1875 Wt. W593/826 1,000,000 4/15 J.B.C. & A. A.D.S.S./Forms/C. 2118.